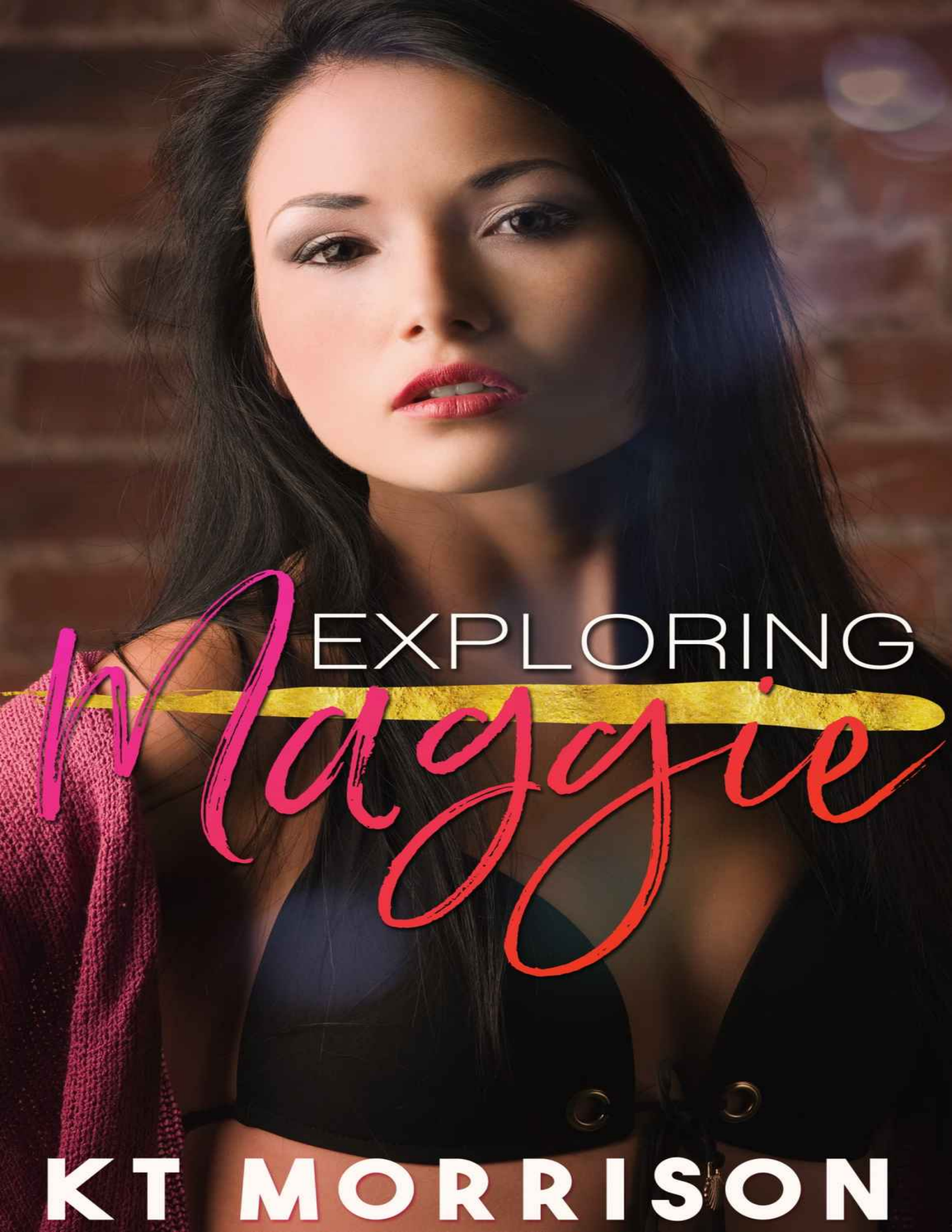




EXPLORING

Maggie

KT MORRISON

EXPLORING MAGGIE

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EXPLORING MAGGIE

A MAGGIE novella.

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MAGGIE FOUND the crowds of students at Vermont State to be overwhelming. Farmingham had under two thousand students, and here at State there was maybe six or seven times that. She walked on a path that skirted the outside of the campus, trundling along in a flux of students she couldn't get past. She followed along with them like flotsam until the trail diverged into three and she cut to the right. Now she headed to the center of the campus in lighter traffic. VSU was a big school with a sprawling campus, but the age of the buildings surprised her. They looked older than the ones at Farmingham.

She followed behind two girls with black hair who talked in hushed voices to one another. She heard their quick patter of Cantonese. Getting next to them she asked if they knew the way to Drillfield. They nodded and pointed, eyed her warily but smilingly.

She followed the direction of an aimed finger, turned and asked if it was far and they both shook their head no. "Thank you," she said, nodded and smiled graciously, headed where they had aimed her.

She hustled now, the path open and wide without much obstruction. At the next intersection, under a tangled network of old oak branches, she read a directional sign. It pointed to the northwest for Drillfield. She went on her way again, glancing at her watch. It was just after ten in the morning now, her travel to Rhode Island would begin at 1 P.M. This was cutting it close. She hated cutting it close on anything, but somehow this was all right. Like it heightened the wrongness. This was yet another thing Maggie Becker

would never do in a million years. She was doing it. She quickened her step.

Ahead, looming like red brick spires from the campestral expanse she assumed must be Drillfield, was the main campus building. It was a four-story Gothic Revival monolith, a tower in the middle poked up with a pointed roof. It looked exactly like Nassau Hall in Princeton, but this was in red brick. It screamed Ivy, but it technically wasn't.

And there in its early morning shadow, spread out on the grassy field, were the milling forms of student athletes and a gathering crowd of spectators. The Athletic Department had set up a wrestling demo, arranging five mats on the grass of the field, wrestling-marked circles in the middle with the VSU logo blazed across the center. Preparing at the edges of the exhibition mats were wrestlers in tracksuits and warmup jackets with WRESTLING blasted across the back. Coaches and assistant coaches hashed last minute details with them in a loose huddle.

She saw Jay then, at the front of the huddle, rocking back and forth, kicking each leg loosely in succession, nodding and exhaling, a puff of steam whispering above his head. The head coach, a graying guy in his fifties, tapped Jay on the forehead with papers rolled in a tube, emphasizing something good-naturedly. Some of the other wrestlers laughed. She clenched her fists and opened them, did it over and over, feeling a tension seizing her. Her mouth went dry and her throat clicked when she swallowed.

She approached slowly, trepidation making her muscles work in constricted movement she felt tug at her reluctant joints. She checked her watch again. The bus pickup was in two-and-a-half hours. Moved then into the crowd of spectators that ringed the platforms laying in the grass.

It was brisk out, not enough to make frost of your breath unless you were a warmed up athlete, but cold enough she huddled into her wool poncho. Her arms folded underneath and she ran her hands up and down them under the wool in an absent, worried sort of way. Chewing her lip and hiding in the crowd, she put spectators between her and Jay but kept an eye on him the whole time. There were no socks or tights under her kiltie loafers, legs bare under her above-the-knee-length skirt, and the cold of the grass made wet drops run rivulets on the tops of her feet.

Two hours from now she should be on a Megabus bound from Brattleboro to Boston, then on a train to Wickford Junction. There would be

a limo for her. She would take it home and she would stay with her parents, and on Saturday she would select a wedding dress to wear on the day this next summer she married the boy she loved. What she planned between now and that bus trip was absolutely insane. Yet her tummy fluttered, her heart raced, its suction whoosh echoed in her ears. She might not do it. She didn't have to...

The athletes undressed. Pulling off their snap-away pants and doffing their satiny jackets. Her eyes focused only on one wrestler. Jay Carmichael, star athlete, star student, multiple scholarship winner, handsome, muscular, driven, hung. Not the man who put the ring on her finger. Jay's amiable face chatted and nodded, encouraged his teammates as they came together and this exhibition got itself under way.

Jay had been previously working out or warming up. She knew his body, having spent time with it naked, drawing it; then later, touching it and kissing it. His veins roped his arms, two thick ones running up his biceps and slipping into the round globes of his muscular shoulders. His skin shone with the vibrance of activity. An excitement began low inside her.

Not someone who gave an ounce of concern for sports or wrestling she suddenly was aware of a psychic arousal swirling in her. A desire to watch her man best other men.

Her man? That's a little possessive...

Jay's head rolled on his wide neck, he bounced it from side to side. She had got herself hidden behind a tall State student with dreadlocks, standing and talking to his friend with his hands tucked into his front pockets. Maggie peered around the guy's JanSport, watching, but not wanting to be caught.

Like the other wrestlers, Jay wore a wrestling singlet. Some of the other team members wore T-shirts underneath, but Jay was bare-chested. The singlet was a satiny, midnight-steel blue; white trim in a band around the cuff of the short leg that ended high up at the top of his thigh. She thought they would wear a jock or something but he clearly wasn't. None of the other boys were either. There was a tightening in her belly, low and primordial, and the feel of it made her laugh at herself. How primitively wicked.

Some of the boys headed across the squares set in the grass, pairing up with similarly sized partners. The coach and his assistant, a burly young guy with a long beard, each pointed and maneuvered their athletes out into the

throng. More people had gathered. The delay seemed to come from waiting for a camera crew to set up at the perimeter. The camera had the NCAA logo blazed on its side.

As Jay passed from the enclave of athletes out to the mats, a hand from the crowd reached out and lay on his chest, stopping him. The hand was thin, elegant, black, feminine.

The student standing between the hand-wielder and Maggie, leaned to their side to say something to a friend, and she got a glimpse of the girl who'd stopped Jay. She was tall, beautiful, long-limbed and graceful; a pair of jeans clung to her endless legs. Her hair was bleached auburn, hanging in tight curls that spilled over her narrow shoulders and down to the middle of her back where they grew frizzy and almost blonde. Her skin was smooth and caramel, her smile effortless and white and wide. She whispered something to Jay, drew him close to her and he fell for it, leaning in to hear and she cupped that pretty hand on his neck and told him something that made him laugh. His hand rested on her hip.

Without realizing it, Maggie's expression had melted from anxious and eager to a down-turned grimace of anger. When she caught herself she shook her head and forced a smile for her own sake. Watching Jay talk to another attractive girl had roused a fury in her she hadn't expected. Jay could talk to a girl. Jay could date girls. Jay could have sex with them...

She held that fury, examined it like a fiery comet, marble-sized, held in between her thumb and forefinger.

It brought a sneering smirk to her face, chastising herself at such a ludicrous emotion. Though addressing it didn't seem to lessen its hold on her. She watched this girl get in a few more moments of his time before he tapped her waist and trotted to catch up with his teammates. She had left a smile on his face. They hadn't kissed though, not even an attempt. As she contemplated that, a hand came to rest on her shoulder and a familiar deep voice said, "Margaret, Margaret, what are you doing here?"

HER HEART THUMPED in her chest and her head turned on her creaky neck. Knew who it was before she saw him. She recognized the voice from lectures. Professor Carmichael. Jay's father. Her mouth fell open, and no

sound came out. She stammered for a moment, croaked, said, "Puh-Professor Carmichael..."

Professor Carmichael laughed, his head rolling back and his mouth showing his perfectly even and viciously white teeth. "Did I startle you?"

"Yeah," she admitted, laughing sheepishly with him.

"We're both a long way from Farmingham," he said.

"We are," she agreed with a smile. "I'm just passing through. I'm heading home for the weekend..."

"Ah," he said. He extended a long finger over to the mats, said, "I'm here to watch my son. We're heading away as well. Not far, just to have dinner with his mother in Ogunquit."

She watched Jay now, walking to an empty square, another boy waiting in the center of the painted circle for him. Jay was strapping his headgear on, cups over his ears, fastening the strap under his chin.

She was frozen on what to say. *Did she know Jay was his son? Does she know Jay at all?* Nodding slowly, she watched the two wrestlers get in a crouch.

He continued, "Jay's D1, today's an exposition...they don't start the conference until the first week of November, but Jay...Jay is predicted to be in the NCAA Championship next spring. We work him pretty hard..."

"Uh-huh," she said. Jay launched an attack on his opponent and thrust his arms around his hips. His leg shot out, and he threw him over his own hip and took him to the ground. "Wow," she said, "he's fast."

"He is..."

Jay won the point, or whatever happened... She was unfamiliar with the rules. A coach called the play and they stopped. Jay looked pleased and his opponent did not. They set themselves up again, the two of them facing each other.

"And how is school for you this year, Maggie? You were one of my better students..."

"It's going well," she said absently, eyes still on Jay.

"Good, good. What are your plans for graduation?"

Jay exploded again, the two of them coming together hard, slapping their bodies against each other. Jay's arms slipped around the other kid, a strapping corn-fed farm boy, and he locked one arm out so it was useless. They both struggled for control but it looked like Jay had the upper hand. Straps of muscle in his thighs stood out, his arms bulged and flexed.

Her eyes still on the action, she said, "I'm getting married in the summer, then..."

Professor Carmichael paused her with a long-fingered hand, eyes shut in concentration. Well-groomed, hair in a close-cropped halo, his black skin was much darker than Jay's and it gleamed in the fall sunlight. He wore a tweed jacket and chambray shirt, a striped bowtie, and with his arm held up she saw matching braces in the gap of his open lapels.

"Max," he said, "Max, correct? ...I'm sorry, I've forgotten his last name..."

"Milton," she said with a smile.

"Max Milton," he said with a grin. "Smart kid, Maggie. He's handsome too..."

She beamed. "I know... I'm marrying him." She chuckled, then added, "I'm picking out my wedding dress this weekend."

"Congratulations, Margaret. I wish you lots of happiness."

"Thank you, sir," she said.

"And after the wedding? Have you plans? ..."

"No..."

"Nothing post-grad? ..."

"I don't know," she said.

Jay had his opponent now in a hold, the two of them arms locked over one another, both on their back, side by side. Jay's heels were planted in the mat, his back arched. The generous bulge between his legs jiggled under the satin singlet.

"You're an excellent student, Margaret. You should consider..." He stopped to applaud, his big hands slapping together in controlled enthusiasm for Jay who had just won his third match.

Maggie clapped as well, said, "I *have* been thinking recently..."

"You're no longer in my class, but my office is always open."

"Thank you," she said.

When she looked back to the match her face fell. Some of the mats were clearing out, new wrestlers coming on, and Jay's opponent headed back toward the coaches. Jay was off the mat, feet in the grass, coming their way, less than ten yards away. He was pulling the headgear off, his face incredulous and pulled up brightly.

"Maggie?" he said from far away.

She froze. Afraid to move, horrified to look to her side and see Professor Carmichael. Her mouth hung open again, and she attempted to close it. Jay strode toward them, getting a clap on the back from a spectator as he passed. He drew close, and he said, "Hey, Dad," but he kept his eyes on hers.

He came to her with his hands held out, palms up. She was drawn to him, drawn to his eyes, his smile. Meekly, her hands raised and he took them and held them. He kissed her cheek.

When he pulled back, he said, "I can't believe you made it. Maggie, I'm so glad you're here..."

"Yeah," she said breathily, painfully aware of his father's gaze turned her way.

"I thought you had to go to Rhode Island?" He held her hands still and loomed over her, his handsome face glowing with ardor. His teeth were as perfect as his father's, eyes gray but in the cold, early morning light she could see flecks of frosty blue.

"I do. I...my bus leaves from Brattleboro...I came...early..."

"Aw, I...thanks for coming, Maggie, I mean it...you know my Dad..." he said, letting her hands go and including his dad on their conversation now.

"Yeah," she said guiltily, "We were just catching up."

Professor Carmichael nodded reservedly, his eyes on his son with scrutiny.

Jay threw a glance over his shoulder, saw the new matches underway. He said, "I've got two more rounds of matchups. Forty minutes. Give me twenty for a shower. Let me take you out and get a coffee. What time is your bus leaving?"

"At one..."

"That gives us an hour." He laughed again, a breathy exhalation, said, "I'm really...I just can't believe you came." Their eyes held for too long a moment, then he turned and trotted back to the coaches and hopped in place trying to keep warm while he waited.

Maggie stayed where she stood, her feet nervously shuffling in the grass, her gaze locked forward desperate for release from the proximal dread, standing next to a smart man who most definitely knew what she was up to.

Exhibition

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 5TH

MAX WATCHED Jay wrestle while sitting at the base of a wide Scotch pine on a slight rise from the exhibition area. Jay in his skimpy singlet never lost, manhandling men of the same size and even larger. His muscles popped and bulged. His skin took a wet sheen like the day Max had watched him fuck Maggie while hidden in her roommate's closet.

Standing in the crowd (watching with lustful intent, he was sure) was his fiancée, the woman he'd followed here. She'd warned him. Told him to keep an eye on her.

She stood in a woolen poncho and skirt, her hair pulled back neatly, a twisting black, blue, and platinum tail down her back. Next to her stood her lover's father. A man they both knew. Farmingham's intellectual keystone, tenured professor, tall and handsome Professor Carmichael. They watched his impressive offspring get the better of every contender and they applauded.

The matches were held at the foot of the main college building and most people just passed by on the pathways, looking over mildly and not breaking their step. Spectators gathered and watched, but not enough to close the spectacle off completely. It allowed Max to watch from a safe distance. His belly was hard like a rock. His jaw ached from keeping it clenched too long. He couldn't believe she had come here. Couldn't believe that she would want to do this.

His chin came to rest on his knees that he had bent up, feet in the grass, arms around them. Maggie was so beautiful and he couldn't love her more. He watched her profile, her exquisitely shaped jaw and pouting lips, her

long black lashes scoring her narrow sultry eye. She looked nervous but excited just the same. She hadn't expected Professor Carmichael to be there he figured, given her reaction to his greeting.

His phone buzzed in his hand and he flipped it around to see the screen. His brother, Connor.

"What's up, dipshit?" he said as an introduction.

"Dude, you're not coming home?"

"Nah. I have too much work to do. I've...fallen way behind..."

"Shit, man. I didn't know you weren't coming home..."

"So what? ...What about Mike?"

"Nah, he's not coming either."

"That's last minute..."

"Yeah, some girlfriend or some shit."

Jay had been off to the side, his matches done, but now he was being waved on again. He strode out with energy, reattaching his headgear as he went. When he faced his opponent in the center, he crouched low, his head up, watching the other wrestler from under his brow. He didn't look mean or fierce. Calculating. That's what it was. He knew he could beat this other guy, was just waiting to see how his opponent would let him win. He didn't need to get in the guy's head, didn't need trickery of any kind. He would win with skill and strength. And he did, the first point going to him in under five seconds.

Max said, "It's just Columbus Day, Connor. I'll see you at Thanksgiving."

"Mm," he hummed with irritation. "So... What? ...You going to Maggie's?"

"No, I'm solo, I told you. I have a total shit-ton of reading to catch up on. She's going home by herself. Her parents have her booked up. She's picking out her wedding dress."

"That's nice," he said, the speaker on his phone muffled and his voice was constrained with exertion.

"What are you doing?"

"Laying on the couch."

"You're at home? You're already there?"

"Yeah. Why you think I'm mad? If I knew you and Mike weren't coming I could've just bailed..."

"How's Mom and Dad?"

“Fine. Dad’s at work. Mom’s making me breakfast right now.”

Max laughed, “You sound mad, but everything you’re saying seems pretty good...”

“I know, I know. I’m going to be bored.”

“You got a girl you’re missing?”

“Me? No.”

“How about that blonde girl? ...Marley?”

“Yeah, I see her sometimes. Others too...”

“Hound dog.”

“Love em and leave em, Maxy.”

“Mm. You don’t know what you’re missing.” Maggie was applauding now, her pale hands coming together in furtive, delicate resounding. The claps sounded disjointed and distant in all this open space. Her ponytail shook with her movements.

Jay was back up again, tugging at the legs of his shorts, getting down in a crouch to start it all over.

“Yeah, you’re a lucky guy. How is Maggie?”

“The best,” he said, watching her watch her lover throw lesser men around, knowing she was excited, knowing that her heart rate would be elevated by this other man.

“Yeah, too good for you, that’s for sure.”

“Don’t say that.”

“You keep an eye on her, buddy. She might catch on what a pathetic little worm you are.”

“Fuck you.”

Connor laughed with honest jubilation, always happy to land one too close to the mark. “Nah, I have faith in you. You’ve fooled her this long, you got that wool right over her eyes.”

He heard his mother’s voice in the background then. Her familiar lilting sing-song, calling out, *Con-nor, break-fast*.

“Better go feed your fat fucking face, asshole,” Max said with comical coldness.

Connor laughed, said, “You bringing her to Thanksgiving?”

“Yeah,”

“Tell her I said Hi, buddy.”

“I will.”

“Ciao. Gotta go annihilate about a dozen pancakes and some bacon.”

“See you,” he said, turning the call off without taking his eyes away from his dirty little Maggie.

The match was wrapping up below. While Max discussed home life at the Milton Compound, he’d watched Jay take down and submit or score on the bigger farm-boy. The farm-boy wasn’t angry—as though Jay was already determined the winner. Like he won by pedigree. So far the obvious champion his opponent merely submitted to fate, not once believing he would be the victor at all. Jay was certainly the center of attention. His teammates deferred to him, the coaches doted. A camera crew, one with a professional looking setup befitting national news, had recorded the activities but the camera mostly had followed Jay. And up front, most telling of all, was the woman he was engaged to marry. She stood side by side with Jay’s father and she watched him. Watched her lover display his masculine superiority with his tight unitard and his muscles and his bulge noticeable even from here. Shouldn’t they be made to wear jockstraps? It was vulgar.

But in many ways, Max admired him.

SHE SHOULD HAVE TOLD Professor Carmichael something. Said something about how she knew Jay and why he might hold her hands and kiss her cheek. Instead, she had said nothing and let the moment pass. Like she was too afraid to mention it, afraid he would read her guilt in her voice, in her face, so instead she ventured nothing. But that was an admission of a sort, just the same. It wasn’t the reaction of someone who was only an innocent friend of his son; someone who would say what a great guy Jay was, how she knew him, how they met... She said nothing, and in that nothing was volumes. Volumes of weight and meaning. What did he think?

He was smart. He knew his son’s worth, knew what appeal he had. Probably could read in his son’s attention to her that they had been intimate. So profoundly embarrassing.

When the match had ended, Jay had signaled to her with two fingers, mouthing the phrase *Twenty minutes* with a nod, a wink, and a confident smirk. Professor Carmichael had said he had to meet a colleague for lunch and politely extricated himself from her company with a plastic smile. He

did, however, pause, look down thoughtfully, and then he told her he was serious about his office being open to her. That if she needed to talk, he would love to listen. There was a passing glimmer in his eye, something warm, and in that moment she felt some of the fiery shame extinguished. She thanked him; he waved and slipped into the pathway traffic.

Now she sat on a granite boulder protruding from the grass at the edge of a path near the door she had seen Jay disappear beyond. The sun was bright and its touch was warm but the air had a chill. Nonetheless, she had her bare legs stretched out straight and held together, the heels of her loafers pitched in the grass. She didn't like to get sun, liked her pale pinkness, but the feel of it was nice.

Her mind wandered to Jay and what he might be doing. The dirty thought crossed her mind that he would be naked right now, standing under a spigot of hot water, rubbing slippery soap all over his hard muscles. She entertained the notion of slipping in there, imagining him alone, without his teammates. She could come in behind him, watch him a moment. Then, when he caught her looking, he would take her, pin her to the wall. And unlike the day in the co-ed washrooms of Keegan, when she had clumsy sex with her Max, she imagined Jay would pick her up and throw her around like a toy; she could run her hands over him while he banged her off every wall in the boys washroom. Her legs up around his hips, his big arms wrapped around her, that huge thing he had penetrating her substantially, no matter the angle. Then she pictured him not alone. Pictured his whole team watching, wondered what shape their faces would form as they bore witness to their team captain fuck some little naked whore in the shower. Some tramp who wandered in looking for some action...

"Maggie? ..."

She flinched; her legs jumped and her knees drew up as if to protect herself. In that moment she was distinctly aware of a warm lubrication in the creases between her legs.

She laughed seeing Jay's face in comical puzzlement. Her sunglasses had shielded her eyes, and he struggled to read her expression. He said, "Did you fall asleep?"

"I might have," she laughed, her hands coming up and absently testing the heat on her cheeks, worried she was blushing. She put her sunglasses in her pocket.

He held his hand out to her and helped her to stand, said, "Let me buy you a coffee before you have to go."

"I'd love that," she said, and when she stood she didn't let his hand go.

It was a weird moment. She stood with him, looking up into his eyes. They stared at each other for a long while, faces working in restrained mirth, eyes darting and studying, trying to glean from one another what each of them intended. They broke into smiles and Jay kept her hand in his and led her to the path.

"You did well out there," she said.

"Thank you," he said. "Just an exhibition."

"Your dad said you're going to the Championships..."

Jay laughed, shrugged. "That's a long time from now. A lot can happen."

"I have faith in you," she said and squeezed his hand.

"One thing at a time. Conference is next month. How about you? I want to pose for you again..."

"I'm finished."

"Oh."

"Sorry. I couldn't have it hanging over me. That drives me crazy. I used other models."

"Did I let you down?"

"Not at all, Jay. It's...I'm getting married in the summer."

Shoulders hunched, he rolled his head around.

She continued, "*I canceled on you*. I...I feel so guilty about what we did."

"Don't feel guilty," he said without looking at her.

"I do. And this? ..." she said while giving his strong hand a squeeze, "...is so dangerous. You know I know your dad? Well, you come up to us after I finished telling him I was getting married this summer. You kissed my cheek and held my hands... Your dad knows Max."

"I was excited to see you."

She glanced at him, gave him a smile. "You gushed."

"It wasn't very manly, was it?" He smiled now too.

Truth was it had turned her insides to jelly. If his father hadn't been standing at her side, she would have crammed her tongue down his throat.

He said, "I don't know where that puts us. You don't need me to pose for you, you're getting married, it's dangerous to be seen with me...but you're

here...you came to see me...you're holding my hand..."

She stopped, and he stopped with her. They stood still on the path and pedestrians passed around their obstruction. Looking in his eyes made her heart beat furiously. She struggled with what to say and Jay's gaze lowered to her lips, parted and struggling to form words.

"Maggie, I think about you all the time. I think about what we did, how you felt, your skin..."

He brushed his knuckles against her cheek.

"I didn't say I didn't want the danger."

Gray eyes roamed her face, his hand dropped to cradle her jaw. His plump lips lowered to hers and her eyes closed, her lips parted, and she let herself be kissed.

HE SIGHED when he saw Jay's lips come together against Maggie's. Jay had plump lips, masculine still, and he and Maggie had pressed together so slowly that Max could witness the soft shapes osculate against one another; press and squash and join in some combined shape, two sets of lips becoming one.

Jay stood taller than Maggie, his head bent to hers, one big hand on her waist, the other holding her face to be kissed, stilling her against his gentle passion. Max's heart beat strongly once, a powerful surge, his ears rang; his cock grew. Maggie came up ever so slightly on her toes to meet Jay's kiss; a line of muscle stood out as her calves flexed on her slim, pretty legs.

When they came away, Maggie still held Jay's gaze. They stared into one another and Jay licked his lips. Letting her chin go, he took up her hand, and they walked down the path again.

Max stayed close, but not so close that one of them might discover him. He wasn't sure if Jay even knew what he looked like. He knew Max existed. Knew, and had such little respect for the sanctity and protocol of a wedding engagement that he'd seduced her, then fucked her in her own dorm room. Jay was a player. Dominant, and masculine, and smart. He'd played dumb games with Maggie almost as though he didn't respect her either. I mean, telling her he needs to jerk off to make an erection go down. That wasn't true. He lied to her; thought she was sexually immature enough to fall for that. What was he up to? What did he want from Maggie? Was it only sex?

Weaving through Drillfield, meandering gravelly paths, flattened grass, dirt trails, they came to a wide concrete walk that ran under towering oak trees with leaves that had lost their vibrant fall color, still hanging stiffly in their branches, gone the shade now of bright ochre. He lost sight of them a few times in the fluxing throng of students. Keeping his pace, he didn't panic, caught up with them. They still held hands. It still made him hard. The jacket he wore reached the tops of his thighs, and he kept his arousal pointing up; no one would see it.

Soon they came to another clearing. They were away from the parking, deep in the campus, and now in a different park. This one lesser in scale, more pronounced in substance. Tiered planters, a fountain, benches...there was an open field beyond, tree-lined, bordered by a dense wood. The grass plain was dotted with tight clutches of students gathered on blankets, laying under broad elm trees, chatting, napping, and reading. There were two separate groups playing frisbee, and one group playing Hacky Sack. To the right, near the fountain, was a small, low building with a peaked roof, styled to mimic a Swiss mountain chalet. It was an open-air café with a lineup of students waiting to order coffee from the uniformed baristas standing at a polished wood counter.

Jay took Maggie by the hand and they waited in line. Max wandered past them, keeping his distance, looped around the fountain, stood hidden behind it and watched them. They stood in line, their hands together. How long were they going to do that for? It seemed so loving. This was more than just being bad, being naughty, this was distinctly cheating now. Holding hands was an act of affection, not lust. Why would she want that from another man?

The two of them talked, flashed smiles at one another that seemed to sparkle in the fall sunshine. Maggie cocked her head as he spoke, absorbing his words, responding with affectionate nods. They ordered.

When their drinks were ready, they took them and walked near the fountain, side by side—no longer holding hands—and they crossed between the two thick elm trunks, into the grass, and wandered through the field.

Max angled left, walked the path still, his eyes on them. The path crossed an iron bridge over a stream. At the bank of the stream were woods—the same woods that formed the tree-line that rimmed the field. Exiting the path before crossing the bridge, he got on the grass and walked casually along the edge of the woods, his hands in his pockets.

Maggie and Jay had made their way across the field and were up ahead, in his line of vision now, getting themselves to the woods' edge so they were out of everyone's way; so they could be alone. Max slipped into a gap between two cedars and onto the hard pack of the woods' floor, the atmosphere cool and dark. Pathways beat around the trees from students crossing through occasionally, but mostly it was littered with beer bottles and wrappers and dried brown evergreen needles. He wound his way through the trees, headed in the general direction of where he'd last seen them. When he thought he was close, he hitched right, headed to the bright sunshine filtering through the break in the woods.

When he came to the edge, he saw them not more than two dozen feet from his vantage point. Maggie held both their drinks—two tall lattes, steam billowing from lids, corrugated cardboard sleeves under her fingers—and Jay lay his jacket on the grass so they could sit. He took the drinks, and Maggie slipped her poncho over her head and lay it next to Jay's jacket. They sat.

Max watched them for fifteen minutes but couldn't hear what they were saying. Every once in a while Jay would say something that would make her laugh, and she would throw her hair back and a half second later he could hear her sweet familiar sound, out of sync with the movement of her mouth.

This was burning him. Igniting in him a bed of glowing coal. Not jealousy this time, not some exquisite, tortured pain he could hold his hand up to and feel its heat, let it warm him. This was a temperature he didn't like. This was anger. It was pointed and sharp and had little of that slippery chrome pleasure that he enjoyed when she was sexually intimate with Jay. This was too far, and he didn't know why she thought this was okay.

He wanted to cry with the pain of seeing her happy with another man, just sitting and talking; he saw how vulnerable he was, and how fragile their love could be. Under that virtual sadness was rage. He wanted to smash, and rail, and scream in anger. Throw a tantrum. That's all he could do. Wouldn't last two minutes with Jay; he'd just spent an hour watching him throw men around that were twice Max's size.

So he watched, and he steamed, and he explored his sadness. She mesmerized him. She was beautiful. He watched her profile as she talked, her mouth held in a perpetual half-smile, that smile opening like a flower, her whole face lighting up when she was amused. Eyes sparkling, her lips

gleamed with a glossy sheen—she was his angel. He wouldn't lose her. He would do anything for her.

Jay's laugh was a low sound. He sat cross-legged while Maggie hugged her knees and cocked her head, bashful eyes narrowed on him, being flirtatious. Jay talked and listened, and he tossed blades of grass into the breeze.

Then Maggie bit her lower lip, her eyes held on Jay's. They seemed to stop talking as Jay realized this signal she was sending him. White teeth clenched that plump lower lip of hers, and her shy little mouth peeled into a hesitating smile. Slowly their mouths came together again, and as they got closer Maggie's eyes lowered to watch Jay's lips. They kissed.

He was stabbed again, deeply and painfully. Maggie was a young student falling in love. Max didn't exist in her world, and she was happy and carefree to explore her sexuality, her identity. It focused his mind on his possession of her. He burned for her. She was his. Short of being property, she belonged to him. That was absolute. She'd said she would marry him, she'd said *A-thousand-times-yes* to his proposal. What did it all mean? Just sex, Maggie. This is just sex. What you are doing right now is so wrong.

Yet, between his legs, his cock had become throbbing steel.

KISSING TURNED to fondling and Max wanted to be closer. He was frozen to the spot for the moment. Jay's hand touched Maggie. He watched it intently, noted the hesitation; not afraid or bashful, but drawing out the moment, eking out the most enjoyment from that initial contact. It gripped her upper arm. Then the kiss broke, and he looked in her eyes.

That hurt. So Max took the opportunity to work himself closer to them.

It took painstaking movement; the ground littered with needles and other dry things apt to make a noise if he stepped on it. But he made his way around, going slow, keeping his eyes down, letting them dart up to keep abreast of what they did. He managed to get himself another dozen feet closer, cutting the distance between them in half. Aware of his own breathing, his own sounds, he hoped that it was only loud in the insulated space he was in, the tight enclosure of trees and shrubs; that any sound he made, once past the tree line, would get eaten up with wide open spaces,

shouts from frisbee throwers, seagulls, and rustling leaves. The two of them made no movement like they heard something suspicious; they were caught up in each other.

Now he squatted down, the stiff blades of a cedar irritating the back of his neck. But he was closer, his view unobstructed. He could even hear the sounds their lips made against one another.

With one hand still on her shoulder, his other hand lay across the top of her bare thigh, just below the hem of her skirt. That simple touch sprang him even stiffer, his cock growing uncomfortable in the tightness of his briefs. He fought the urge to adjust it, worried being so close provided too many opportunities to get discovered. He let his cock suffer.

Maggie put her hand over Jay's. It was small and pale compared to his thick-veined caramel skin. They continued to kiss, and while he'd thought that she had put her hand down on his to control him, to stop him from being too forward, it was evident now that wasn't the case. It seemed like she was inching his hand higher up her thigh. Her fingers had closed around the back of his hand and she seemed to guide him under her skirt. Jay's hand was happy to oblige, and it slowly slipped under the plaid fabric of her short skirt.

When his hand was hidden underneath the skirt, Jay's smile broke their kiss and he looked in her eyes. He spoke her name in the tone of surprise and admonishment. Indicating to her that she was a bad girl. Hand moving under her skirt, their eyes darted over one another. Maggie's expression went placid, her attention focused on what his hand did below. Eyelids heavy, her lips parted. Then her eyes closed as Jay continued to do things under her skirt. Jay contemplated her face intently. He kissed her cheek.

Legs parting wider, she sat on one hip, opening like butterfly wings, one foot planted on her poncho that she lay on. She kept her calf blocking the view up her skirt, in between what Jay's hand was doing and the students farther out in the field. But as her skirt rode up higher, a curve of her ass cheek was revealed to him. The dark woolen material bunched in the seam of her hip and folded away. Bare ass cheek exposed, the pale curve of it revealed to him, it was apparent that his Maggie was not wearing panties. She'd come today prepared for this. Wasn't just dropping by to see how Jay was doing, she had prepared for something like this to happen. She wanted it.

A sickness rose in him. Thinking of her at home today, this morning, getting dressed, knowing she would make a detour before she got on the bus. Purposely deciding, *I'm not putting on my panties. It will be better for Jay to stick his hand up my skirt and touch the part of me that belongs to Max. Maybe even worse. Maybe I'll let Jay sneak that big cock up inside me. Right up my skirt! I won't even have to undress!*

Sickness, bile, and a swirl of blood-red anger came up his throat and he swallowed it. It burned like acid. He felt so betrayed. She was letting him down. He called her a slut and she loved it. He called her a slut and she hated it. Hated that it might be true. Here it was, Maggie. It was true. You are a slut. A no good dirty slut.

Two guys ran out deeper in the field, one tossing a football to himself. Maggie closed her legs, and they broke their kiss. They both watched the two guys for a moment. They weren't too close, but Maggie was wary. She worked herself closer to Jay, rolled towards him, taking a corner of her poncho that she sat on with her, covering herself as she went. On her belly, her elbows in the bare grass, Jay took up the poncho now and he put it over her waist and rump. He lay next to her, on his side and they spoke too quietly for Max to understand what they were saying. Jay's hand moved underneath the poncho. Maggie parted her legs and Jay must have slipped his hand between her ass cheeks, his fingers stroking her pussy from behind, maybe even toying with her anus. Maggie smiled past his kissing lips, Max seeing the corner of it pull up one pretty cheek. Her ponytail hung down her shoulder and onto the grass under her chin.

Maggie's hand crawled Jay's belly, working like spider legs to get lower, get between his legs, but the angle was twisting her arm up, her shoulder moving high as it would go but she couldn't reach. Eager Jay tried thrusting his bulge towards her reaching hand but she gave up. Now she eased herself to her side to face him, his hand lifting the poncho for a moment while she got comfortable. Max saw right underneath—her bare legs, her ass cheek, her shaved mound... Then the poncho covered her again, and Jay's hand continued to play with her, tenting out the fabric with his movements.

Her hand was free to explore. She broke her kiss, her head turned to the field to see if they were watched. Not realizing someone was, from the opposite direction, and only a dozen feet away, hidden in the bushes.

Jay wore a sweatshirt, jeans, and expensive basketball shoes. Maggie's hand worked down to his jeans, felt around the denim until she discovered

the shape of his manhood underneath. Then she gripped it, gave it a light stroking. He was huge and erect under the fabric. Max saw the shape of it in her hand. The view was blocked as their faces came together to resume their kissing. Both of them making out in the fall sun, touching each other's genitals where anyone could see. It was so unlike her and, mad as he was, he didn't hate her. He had an explosion inside; one that made him want to scream, to fight, to yell, but also, and more likely, to watch. To enjoy. To witness her badness. Compersion. It froze him to the spot.

When her two hands came together, trying to work Jay's zipper down, his breath clutched in his throat and he held it. He couldn't believe it. There were people around. Many people. She was being a whore. The kind of girl she and he might have made fun of a month ago. Some horny freshman. There was no excuse. She wasn't a kid. She was grown up. She was engaged.

It was him that spurred this. He'd wanted it. But when he had struck this match, he could never have expected finding himself in this fire. It was not a far stretch, he supposed. Hiding in the bushes wasn't far removed from hiding in the closet. And while they had done it together as a couple that time in the dorm room, what she was doing right now wasn't *that* nefarious because these were all things she had done before and done it right in front of him.

Was it all the same? The pain now was as sharp as before, but this time her piercing arrow dipped in the poison of betrayal. This was killing him. Some anfractuious thing grew inside him—something hatched, twirling and writhing with reptilian ugliness. It wasn't entirely bad.

The button on the top of his jeans popped and her hands shook with its release. She slipped a hand inside his fly while they both regarded each other. A football thudded nearby, hopping up and twirling end over end, coming to rest a few yards from them. Maggie slipped her hand out and Jay snugged the poncho over her hips, made sure she was covered.

The guy who had missed the catch and been responsible for the ball coming to rest so close to them came to retrieve it. A handsome kid, a jock, with shaggy brown hair, he knew Jay and as he came close to his football, shouted out to him.

Jay answered, gave a mild wave back and a nod of his head. The brown-haired kid stooped for his ball, stood tossing it while he asked Jay more questions. Stuff about the gym, about the wrestling schedule, if he was

going to go to that Kappa party next weekend (he wasn't), about homework, because apparently they were in the same literature class. Maggie's face assumed a polite boredom. Both her hands were up from under her poncho and she watched the guy with the football ask a question then Jay's mouth move as he answered. Jay kept his hips turned toward Maggie, was talking over his shoulder at this other student. All at once, the guy got it; he hesitated mid-question, his expression blank, and it was as if he'd just picked up on something that should have been obvious at the beginning. Guy with girl, laying in grass at back of field out of the way, her poncho covering her waist, they were close and face to face. He stammered, pointed at Jay with the football and he said *All right Jay, catch you later*. He hustled away.

Jay looked at Maggie blankly, his eyebrows a dead even line, the slightest smirk pulling at the corner of his mouth. She looked back, blank as well, and just like his own little Maggie, the one that was his, she couldn't keep a straight face and soon she burst into laughter, clapping her hand over mouth and rolling so she was face down on the grass.

Jay put an arm around her and he kissed her ear. He slipped his hands under the poncho, working with his cock or something, whispering in her ear. She nodded, still with her face in the grass, rolled, kissed his lips quickly, peeked under the poncho before removing it and gathering it into a ball. Jay had zipped himself up.

They stood, brushed at their clothes, blades of grass falling from them and catching in the breeze. The poncho was slipped over her head, Jay put his arms into his jacket. They stood a moment, whispering to each other, Jay's hand under her poncho, laying on her flat tummy. Maggie raised a knee and scratched away grass that had embedded in her skin. They both looked around surreptitiously, two kids up to no good, not wanting to be spotted.

Jay took her hand and together they walked toward the tree line, headed straight for him.

THE SKIN of his scrotum crawled, his balls scrambled up inside his body. His scalp tingled, pins and needles stabbed at his fingers, toes, and across the back of his neck. He had to catch the word *No* from jumping past his lips. They headed right to him. Willing himself to sink low into the dirt, he condensed to the tiniest form his human body would take; nestled under a cedar tree, its bough lay across his neck, and sheltered him well.

But they would pass into the woods just a few feet from him, and he wore a navy coat and tan pants, not exactly camo, not exactly a ninja. Hands forming claws in the dirt, he wondered how mad Jay would be when he found some creep in the woods who'd obviously been spying on him and his girl. Would Maggie interject right away? Would she admit she knew him at all? What would she tell Jay?

"Fuck," he mouthed silently, his mouth shaping it as a scream, his head shaking with fright. He bowed his head as he heard them draw closer; their feet in the grass, their light banter, his Maggie's pretty voice engaged in familiar conversation with another man...discussing the things they were doing...were going to do...

It clutched him. The fear, the lust, the hurt, the jealousy, the abounding love—all too much for his heart. He wanted to explode, wanted to scream, wanted his insides to burst from his flesh and just not have any feelings anymore of any kind. He wanted peace...

Their footsteps passed. Jay said something that made her giggle ... They had gone from his left to his right, passed right by him, heading deeper into the woods. They crushed leaves and snapped twigs, oblivious. His head

raised, and he saw their backs. A bough swayed and danced right in front of him.

As they had passed from the grassy field into the bush, one of them must have swung the bough wide, holding it open like a door, probably Gentleman Jay. It would have concealed where he hid.

“Holy shit,” he whispered and put a hand over his heart. It pounded away in a frenzy. That had been close.

Maggie and Jay worked their way through the paths beaten between the trees, having to duck occasionally, and Jay parted more boughs for Maggie to pass. Their voices grew distant and soon they descended the ravine, their bodies getting lower and lower as they made their way near the stream. Then they slipped from sight and it was quiet again.

Rising, he watched where they had gone; stood then, kicked his legs out. Stiff and sore after yesterday’s workout with Cole, sharp pain also shot through his elbows and shoulder joints.

A few feet down the path they had taken he paused, wondering if this was a good idea anymore. The fear of being discovered, the closeness of that last call, froze him in his tracks. Should he push his luck?

“Why not?” he said to himself angrily. Maggie belonged to him. If she was cheating on him he was allowed this. Even if he watched with hatred, this voyeurism was understandable. If she cheated, and he watched with hatred—and something else, something wild and libertine—that was just as acceptable. Maggie was his. She belonged to him. She wore his ring. He was allowed to watch.

Now indignant he traced their steps to the top of the ridge. Looking down he saw the stream, a path that led that way, see-sawing like a switchback til it came to the steep embankment that dropped to the fast-moving water. No sign of them.

The noises they made would be inaudible. The rushing stream broke across a long line of rocks, dropping a few feet over them, gurgling and splashing. Skewing to the left, he looked right, worked his way across the trail, not along it, going toward the stream in a straight line. He found them.

They were close together, standing under the spreading branches of an oak tree. Long branches reached out over the water, and it fluttered pale yellow leaves. The ground they stood on was overgrown with tall timothy grass that came up to their thighs. Behind them, between their bodies and

the water, was a slab of granite in gray and pale pink. It was rounded, boulder shaped, roughly the size of a compact car. It sat as high as their knees, wedged into the embankment, one-half in the earth, one-half in the water, the stream eddying against its side.

Maggie leaned with her back against the massive tree trunk. Jay loomed over her, one hand on her hip, on hand over her shoulder and planted on the tree. She looked up into his eyes, and they talked. Jay made her laugh.

Jay eyed his own hand, moving lazily, dropping from her waist down to her thigh, and pinching the hem of her skirt. Maggie stopped talking, and she regarded Jay's face. The hem of the skirt was lifted, her bare milky thighs revealed. Higher it rose, showing more and more.

There was an ache in his stomach and his balls now. This hurt like nothing he'd ever felt. Maggie bit her lips as her bare pussy was revealed to daylight and the fall breeze. Jay's hand slipped under her skirt, letting it fall to cover him as his hand worked between her legs. Maggie parted for him. One hand gripping his wrist, she jostled as she planted her legs wider, letting her boyfriend get access to the most private part of her body.

Slowly now *her* hands were moving, coming together again at the button of Jay's jeans. Their lips pressed, the two of them rocking against one another. The zipper was drawn down, her hand went into his fly once more. This time, after a long moment at work behind the denim, she drew his erection out. Maggie stroked it lightly with one hand. It stuck out from his fly, partly hidden in his jeans, but still impressively large, especially from this distance where he could see its proportion to the rest of his body, Maggie's body, Maggie's hand. Twice as long as her fist, easily. Another hand length hidden behind the fly of his opened jeans.

Max settled down while he viewed them. Two lovers hiding away from it all, looking for a little unscheduled quickie. They made out, stroked one another's sex organs. He nestled down in the brush, this time more comfortable without a cedar scratching at his back. He hid himself behind a baby Scotch pine, roughly the same size and shape as his hunched body. He bent tall grass toward him, fanning it out so it would break up the shape of his shoulders.

Now Maggie broke their kiss, hand still pumping, her head twisting to the left and the right. Her knees bent as she squat low, her back leaning against the tree. She took Jay in her mouth. Jay looked around now too, both hands going on the tree as if he were being frisked.

Maggie sunk his glans in her mouth, pulled back. Kissed it. Kissed the hole, raised it, kissed his underside, ran her tongue back up to the tip and sunk him back into her wet mouth. Jay's hips pumped himself into her eagerly. Her pale fingers clamped his thighs as he fucked it into her. It was disgusting, but he wished he was closer, wished he could hear the awful, slick sounds that came with it. He knew what it sounded like when she sucked another man.

JAY'S HEAD looked around now too, wary of being discovered. His eyes lazy, his expression weak with pleasure, Jay looked right at Max, right at the tree he hid behind and didn't see him. Max saw point blank the look of satisfaction that his future wife's mouth put on a man.

She was his semi-virgin, but Maggie was incredible at oral sex. He'd never had a better blow job. She approached it with zeal, not the slightest squeamishness some girls might get. Putting a penis in your mouth had to be gross. Maggie had worked his like an expert. He would never have known his was the first she'd ever put her lips over. Now she'd performed for two other men. His own best friend had received her gifts and had ejaculated in her mouth.

Maggie treated Jay now. Working him over like she could. Showing off a little. He wondered what she planned. Was she going to make him come in her mouth? Was that it? Where they going to fuck as well? Did she have time? His phone showed him she was getting close to her bus leaving.

When Max was convinced that she was going to make Jay come, Jay stopped her. He withdrew it, and her two fists kept stroking and twisting on him, her eyes turned up to his face. He lifted her. Put two hands under her armpits and lifted her up to the tree, pinned her against it with kisses to her neck. One of her knees rubbed up and down the outside of his thighs and her mouth parted, her eyes shut, as Jay whispered what must have been very dirty and exciting things. Between them, one hand still pumped the end of his cock, his glans clamped in her fist.

Jay worked his hips between her legs, his hand up her skirt and stroking her pussy. He guided his cock to her opening, lined it up with his hand and eased himself inside her. Maggie pressed a forearm to her eyes, hid behind

it. Her mouth twisted with pain, baring her teeth in a snarl as she accepted her lover's large size. He stroked easily, shallowly, but after a long moment where they tried to get comfortable together he sunk himself fully and deeply into her and she cried out. Her sound came high and brittle, but it carried over the rushing water and rustling leaves.

Jay fucked her carefully at first. His hips bucking into her. Her thighs climbed up his, her ankles crossing over one another under his rump. Her arms circled around his neck, and now Max saw her face, saw the expression of passion that sex with Jay put on her. Her brows bowed mournfully, her mouth shaped in an O, her eyes closed but placid. Jay worked it into her in protracted circles. His size must have been buried in her given how closely they pressed together. Maggie's nails scratched at the scalp behind his ears, and she said things to him that must have been encouraging.

He held her face in one hand and he spoke to her. Her eyes darted over his as she listened. He kept still, his hips pressed into her, his cock inside her, told her special things that made her eyes dance, her mouth hang open lustily. Then he was moving again. Pumping himself into her, and Maggie squirmed with it, her legs tightening, struggling for better purchase around his powerful legs. They kissed again.

It sunk in his belly like a heavy stone. The passion between them was pronounced. They made love, they kissed, they were intimate. This was a light year beyond fucking her in her dorm room. This was the beginning of something. Like the beginning of a meaningful relationship, one that was sexual and spiritual.

His mouth had gone dry again and he couldn't swallow. He ran his hand over his mouth. His upper lip had taken on a sweat that he wicked away. This was the most hurtful thing imaginable. Yet it was profoundly sexual. The pain congregated like an uncomfortable lump under his balls, hanging heavy below his guts—but it was slippery with his semen, it tickled the underside of his cock as if his Maggie was doing it with the tip of one of her graceful fingers. It was exquisite.

His eyebrows rose, his heart hammered. He loved her so much. He wanted her to have this pleasure. He wanted to have the pain. He cherished the pain she gave him. No one else could do this to him. He never cared for anyone like he cared for her. No one ever meant so much to him that he would feel this way. No one ever meant enough to him that he would enjoy

watching them receive astounding pleasure. No one he knew deserved it like she did. Deserved it because she'd missed it when she was young. Deserved it because she was kind, and loving, and smart, and selfless, and talented. She was everything to him, and all their irregular edges came together so perfectly.

He'd allow her to cheat like this. He'd allow her to pursue the things that made slippery little pulses through her sex. Those dirty, awful things she might dare to think of occasionally when she touched herself. Like he'd hidden and watched her do. Watched her masturbate, watched her make herself come, knowing full well that it wasn't him she thought about. Aroused by the fact that his wife was a sexual being and she had dark corners to her psyche just like he did. All the more reason they were meant for each other. She cried out sharply and passionately again as Jay dug himself deep and bit her neck, his hand clutching a handful of her blue and platinum ponytail. Her cry pierced high and bright and it touched him. He loved those noises she made. Loved to watch her be made to make them. His cock streamed his excitement into his pants and he felt a warm spot growing cold against his thigh.

"Fuck, Maggie," he whispered, watching their lust building.

Jay pounded her now. Grinding and thrusting. His face curled to meanness, her face snarling in ecstasy. Her thighs had climbed above his ass, ankles riding the hard, curved edge of his muscular rump. He lifted her from the tree. Held her in his arms and fucked her while he stood. Her ponytail swung and snapped behind her. She bounced on him with passionate action. Her head lolling, her face twisted in awful pleasure.

He turned with her, kissing her neck, fell on top of her as she was lowered onto the granite boulder. He held the back of her head lovingly, ensuring she wouldn't be hurt when he lay her back. He fucked her again. His hips driving into her madly, eager to fill her up. She wanted it. Wanted her lover to fill her, wanted to feel his seed splash her guts. He could tell by her head twisting on the rock, her nails formed to claws on his shoulders, her heels dug into his rump, urging his thrusts deeper and faster. Sounds were called out by he hardly heard them. She gasped and cried, her lips mouthed the word Yes, over and over.

Jay was over her now, his hands on either side of her ribs, palms spread on the rock. Her hands had slipped under his jacket, probably getting a good feel of his beautiful muscle. His abs, the ridge of his chest. Her skirt was

hiked up to her waist like this, and he saw the bare curve of her ass and her thighs, could even see in bright pink flashes that wet piece of her in between her legs. Saw it being gored by the big, thick, brown thing that her lover had between his. Jay's jeans were still up, his cock poking large and arrow-straight from between the parted fly. Maggie's feet bobbed weakly on her ankles in time with her lover's thrusts. Jay's back arched, bent like a bow. Maggie ran her hands on his hard belly and Jay's thrusting reached a crescendo, Maggie's tight little hole working its hot magic on Jay's big, aching cock. Then he was thrusting and holding, and Maggie's head twisted from side to side.

He knew Jay was coming inside her, knew this impassioned flailing from her was because she was feeling her man's sexual product spewing deep inside her, hot and wet and oh-so-dirty. His big cock was spewing its guts into her and she craved it, satisfied by its splashing in the part that made her a woman.

Her legs ceased their pulling on his hips, she just lay there and took it, took her lover's deep, animal driving, took his roaring and grinding. Jay withdrew far, thrust deep and held it. Maggie cried out. He did it again, withdrew so far that his cock came close to falling out, then he plunged himself into her with every inch he had. She cried out again. Her face pained, but satiated. His head hung over her and he kissed her lips. Her hands ran circles over his shoulders, and she kissed back, but her face didn't come awake yet. Part of her was maybe still orgasming, or riding the wave of ecstasy a young woman enjoyed after exciting, forbidden sex with a capable and exciting partner.

Soon her eyes fluttered and her kissing began renewed. Loving and caring, she took his lips, let her take his. Their energy was restrained, bathing in warmth, not hot and fiery and full of need, but longing and...almost love. The notion stabbed him again. His own brow furrowed. He chewed his own lip. That was awful. It was an awful thought. But somehow this awareness that he could lose her, that she could grow from him, made him love her more, made his passion for her grow tenfold. In juxtaposition with another man, her value to him soared. He needed her more than anything.

Then Maggie broke from the kiss, slipped under Jay's body. Worked herself down underneath him while he still held himself over her. Her face traveled his chest, down lower, down between his legs. He couldn't see

what she was doing, her face hidden behind the open edges of Jay's jacket. "Oh Maggie, oh no," he sighed, realizing she must have his cock in her mouth. Must be down there cleaning up her lover.

Royal Morris

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 5TH

AS HE FOLLOWED her his hands formed fists, let them go, formed fists again. His heart pumped blood through him like jet fuel. There was so much he wanted to do to her. Not hurt her. Never hurt her. Be rough, yes. Passionate, yes. Transfer the hurt she applied to him? No. Not transfer. Translate. That was better. Make her understand.

She walked alone, only a dozen paces ahead of him. Her regularly demure walk had been transformed to some sultry sway he'd never seen from her. Her lover really set her on fire. Jay made her a woman. Walking like she was on cloud nine. Supposed to be headed home to select her wedding dress, supposed to be traveling back to be at home with her family. Instead, this little whore made a detour. Thought he wouldn't figure her out. Bus is in Brattleboro. Jay is in Brattleboro. Followed her. Witnessed that horror. He adjusted his erection. It hid under the jacket, but it stuck upright and aggressive right now.

After Jay and Maggie had fucked...more accurately, made love...they had lingered with each other. Stroking and caressing, speaking unheard words, the nature of them evident by the sweetness in their faces; the smiles...

Both of them were fully clothed, Maggie with her skirt hiked up, pantyless, Jay with his horse cock stuck out of his fly. When it had softened he'd sat next to her on the rock, and she'd watched his hands tuck it away and zip it back up, her hand draped on his thigh. They sat on the rock in the fall sun and talked a bit longer, then Maggie checked her phone, read the time, kissed his lips and they walked out of the woods together.

They parted ways at the café, Jay going left, Maggie continuing on to the right, retracing the route that had brought her here. He knew where she headed so he followed from a safe distance. Followed and watched. And admired.

Her bare legs strutting under her skirt. God, knowing she was completely bare under there. Then, the intoxicating thought that she dribbled another man's semen from that tight, pink slit he loved so much. His cock throbbed harder.

Soon they crossed Drillfield, out past the tall building where the exhibition had been held, the mats cleared away and no evidence left that anything had transpired here an hour ago. Crossing Drillfield they came to a wide walkway, then a busy narrow one that wound them to the edge of the campus.

The crowd thinned at the parking lot, everyone splitting up to head to their individual vehicles, some going in larger clumps headed for the public transport on the main thoroughfare beyond the university parking. Now it was just him and her. Two figures alone, passing an aisle of parked cars, sunlight gleaming off windshields. If she turned she would see him, there was nowhere to hide. He closed the gap.

She stopped at Cole's lifted Jeep. Paused there, standing and waiting, her legs together, looking out towards the main road, biting her lip. He slipped behind her, opened the passenger door to Cole's Jeep with a shaky hand, struggling to slip the key into the lock. Got it, opened it, held the door for her. When her feet were in, he closed the door for her. He couldn't look her in the eye.

He made quick steps to the driver's side, she'd reached across and opened it for him. He climbed in and started the Jeep, his foot pushed on the clutch. His gaze wandered to her side, saw her bare legs held together. His heart raced. He put the Jeep in reverse, backed out, breath trembling, arms still shaky, working through the gears to get them out of the parking. Maggie scratched her neck, looked out the window. The radio hadn't been fixed, and it was quiet in the cabin. He could smell her. Smell her perfume. God, he could smell her sweat. Smell that lovely Maggie smell she produced when she engaged in heated activity; warm and musky, distinct, not like any other woman he had smelled. Sweat had accumulated on his upper lip and he wiped it.

They made their way out of the parking lot, jabbing his credit card in the payment machine, anxious for the arm to lift. Now she touched the hem of her skirt, driving him crazy. She had his attention. Her polished fingernails dragged on her own soft skin, pulling the hem up, lightly fanning herself by wafting the material of her skirt. Like she was hot under there, or she wanted him to smell her.

His eyes snapped back to the road. Traffic was mild, and they made their way from the main lot, through the one-way, narrow, University Lane, past more hundred-year-old red brick buildings with slate spires. It was only a three-minute drive, but it was the longest three minutes of his life. Each heartbeat an aching eternity.

The Megabus pickup was a steel and glass enclosure out front of the Royal Morris Theater, a university-owned building run by the Arts department. He and Maggie had been here once, maybe two years ago, to attend an adaptation of Bram Stoker's *Dracula*. As they neared, her quiet tense voice broke the silence.

"Did you see?"

"Yeah," he croaked.

"See it all?"

God, her words drove him mad. He could feel precum leaking from him, soaking a circle in his pants.

She said, "Max, he came inside me." The hem of her skirt rose and his gaze turned down, desperate to see what she wanted to show him. High up, almost at her pussy, he could see a dull, hazy patch spread on the insides of her thighs. Jay's semen had leaked from her, spread thin on that sweet skin of hers and turned to a glaze.

"You cheated on me," he said, wanting to drop everything and take her right now but knew he couldn't, knew they should save this talk for when they were safe. His eyes darted back to the road. Cole's Jeep had wandered, and he yanked it back between the lines.

"Tell me I'm bad," she sighed.

"I watched my whore girlfriend have sex with another man. I watched her sneak around. I watched her break my heart."

Without her seatbelt fastened, she shuffled herself to the edge of her seat. Now she watched him, and if he turned, if his eyes met hers, he knew he would lose it. So he kept his eyes on the road. Her hand rested on his chest.

“I love you, Max,” she whispered.

“Don’t...” he warned her.

The hand on his chest slipped lower, down his stomach, came to rest between his legs. That was better.

She said, “I can’t help myself, Max. You know how bad I am...”

A smile peeled his cheeks back, and a tremor passed through him with such force his eyes fluttered. He shivered. She gave his balls a careful squeeze. More precum surged from him.

The Jeep bounced the edge of the curb as he careened into the entrance of the theater. They were in a circular drive at the footstep of the red brick theater looming over them. He went around in the drive and wound back up at the one-way University Lane.

“How do I? ... How...”

“I don’t know,” Maggie said, her voice tilting up with a frustrated whine. “I don’t remember...”

Her head snapped left and right, trying to understand where they were—where they could park. The hand she had comforting his throbbing genitals left, a cold dampness seeping through his seams in its absence.

He signaled the Jeep left, continued along the road, took the next left, and it curled around the building adjacent to the old theater. Glancing left he saw the black slate roof of the theater disappear behind another building.

“Shit,” he whispered.

“Up ahead,” Maggie said, wagging a finger at another driveway that slipped down a hill on the left side.

Traffic came toward them and they had to wait for the cars to pass. They sat uncomfortably, Max ready to explode. Car after car slowly passed. The keys for Cole’s Jeep jiggled against the steering column, the indicator gave it steady, maddening *ticka-ticka-ticka*.

“Holy shit, I can’t take this,” Maggie whined, both her hands stroking up and down her bare thighs. She dug her heels into the carpet and shoved her back into the seat. Traffic bunched up, crawling at a snail’s pace, but finally, someone flashed their high beams indicating for him to cut across. They both waved, though their faces were frozen in blank, unsmiling anxiousness. The big tires chirped as he let the clutch out late and the Jeep shot across the lane, into the turn, down the slope and in behind the buildings.

It delivered them to a cramped, tree-sheltered parking lot behind the theater. On the right, above them, near the edge of a retaining wall, a tractor with a claw worked away at excavating, men in yellow hard hats watched from the side; one man's eyes following along, no doubt attracted to the hot Asian girl in the Jeep with the short skirt. On the left was the staff and administration entrance to the theater. The Royal Morris was a hundred-years-old or more, in chalky, red brick, blank and windowless (reminding him of a Masonic Lodge or something), a sharply peaked roof, concrete steps that climbed to a single black door.

There was only one empty spot, and he reeled at the thought of the calamity had there been no available parking. What would they have done?

Maggie rifled through her purse already, pulling out her key chain. They both jumped out and slammed the doors behind them, headed quickly across the lot and to that single door.

"Shit, Max, hurry, hurry," Maggie said, her legs scissoring in short, rapid strokes, her head turned down to the screen of her phone. "Oh Max, we've only got ten minutes."

His mouth struggled to say something, but his jaw had frozen. His eyes were locked on target. That single door up those concrete steps. Ahead of her, he grabbed the yellow hand railing and launched himself up three steps at a time. At the top, he spun and waited, Maggie quick-stepping all the way to him, her hand fumbling for the right key.

Maggie's roommate Jess had a partner in some theatrical/performance piece they were working on for credit, though it was being hosted off-campus at a private gallery in Burlington. The partner attended VSU, gave Jess a key to the Royal Morris, Jess had asked Maggie to ask Max to pick up a prop when he dropped her off to the bus. They borrowed Cole's Jeep.

One twist of the key in Maggie's hand and the black door opened, then they were speeding down a narrow brick-walled hall. Maggie was ahead of him, and she darted through an archway to the left, down a flight of stairs and then they were crossing behind the stage of the theater. It was vacant and quiet. The set was dressed for a play, and they walked past a full-scale reproduction of a suburban backyard; some split-level home in beige vinyl siding. He ran over patio stones and Astroturf, almost knocked over a Weber grill.

On the left, the stage dropped away and empty seating for two-hundred-and-fifty looked blankly at him from the dark. As he hustled to keep up with

Maggie, he fantasized about watching her getting fucked here by Jay, all the seats filled. Jay and Maggie giving all these salivating people a real live sex show, his Maggie with her legs spread on some boulder recreated in papier mâché, surrounded by Astroturf, and a big oak tree overhead, crafted by students in the props department. Jay stroked his cock as Maggie eagerly waited. The audience licked its lips. Jay lowered himself, forced his weapon into her tight wetness. Maggie squealed. The crowd sighed. It was all theater.

Catching up to her in another hall, he loomed over her shoulder as she struggled a key into another lock. A sign on the steel door read PROPS. He was breathing heavy, her breaths coming in excited whines. The lock turned, and she kicked the bottom of the door with her loafer, they stumbled through, and she slammed the heavy metal door behind them. It locked. They were in pitch blackness, her hands scattered around the wall, found a switch and then the room they were in was lit in flickering fluorescence.

He grabbed her roughly, put his arms around her, her nails were under his jacket, scratching his back over his shirt. He kissed her, took her lips by force and she surrendered them, opened her mouth like she'd opened her legs for Jay. He stabbed into her with his tongue, sucked hers into his mouth. Breath scored through their nostrils. His eyes clenched tight, and tears streamed his cheeks. They broke the kiss simultaneously, each taking a step back and regarding one another lustily.

He pulled his jacket off. She threw the poncho over her head. They stared at one another, her hair was a tangled mess. Her makeup practically gone. His hair stuck up in clumps, his mouth hung open, and his chest heaved with his breaths.

"I WATCHED YOU."

Maggie said, "Watched me what?"

His eyes narrowed with menace. "I saw you, you fucking slut."

"Max, I don't know—"

"Liar!" He slapped his hand against the wall just over her shoulder.

"You watched me?" she whined.

His face came close to hers. He said, "I followed you. I saw what you did."

"Oh no," she gasped.

"How could you?"

"You don't understand..."

"What does he mean to you?"

"It's just sex, Max, I swear."

"What does he give you I don't?" Her smell was driving him mad. Up close he could smell her hot skin, her sweet breath. That Maggie sweat. Her sex. He could smell Jay too. Smell his deodorant soap.

"Max...I have needs," she whispered. Her voice soured past his ear and his knees buckled.

"I'm not enough for you?" he whispered to her. His other hand hung loosely between them. It grazed the tops of her thighs, drawing a line where the hem of her skirt touched her skin.

"His body, Max. He has a beautiful body..."

"Smart girl like you? That's what you care about?"

“I like the way it feels. I like what his body feels like under my fingers, Max.”

“You’re a cheap whore.”

“Max?”

“What?”

“Max, he has a huge cock too...”

“I saw it.”

“He fills me up, Max. He fills me so deeply...”

He groaned, now his knees did buckle and his body collapsed against her. Her hands instantly went between them, struggling to get his pants down, happily even more eager than when she had worked Jay's button and zipper.

“Oh shit, Max, fuck me, I need you so bad...”

“Oh fuck, Maggie,” he sighed against her collar. His hands pulled up at her skirt, then stroked up and down her haunches. She writhed under him.

“What did I look like, Max? ...Tell me what you saw...”

“I saw the worst fiancée ever. I saw some cock-hungry little tramp, cheating on her loving man, spreading her legs for some jock...ah...” he gasped as his cock was freed.

He looked down, saw her pale hand grip him, saw a string of semen bowing from him, swaying from the tip of his penis all the way to the floor.

“I saw the hottest woman on earth, Maggie. I saw the hottest woman on earth doing the dirtiest things...”

She was stroking him, his words doing erotic things to her brain. She was shut off, her head tilted back against the door he had pinned her to. Her mouth was agape, her white teeth parted. He took her mouth with his own.

“Do you have a boyfriend, Maggie? Do you?”

“I do, Max,” she whispered.

“Are you having an affair behind my back?”

“My boyfriend is the hottest guy on campus.”

“He fuck you good?”

“He fucks like a st-stallion...he’s just my meathead with a big cock...”

“I know he’s not...”

She chuckled, whispered, “That bother you?”

“Should it?”

“That body, that cock, he’s smart too...”

“Stop.” He pulled from her, his slippery penis squirting right out of her grip.

She said, “Hey...”

“He’s not smarter than me.”

“No, I know. Max, he’s smart. But he’s not you. He’s not funny. He’s not...he’s not my Max. Now, come on... Come on, Max, don’t stop...” She lifted the front of her skirt seductively again, showed him the cleft between her legs.

He came to her, gripped her arms, but before he could kiss her she said, “Max, go down on me...”

“You want that?”

“Max, eat my pussy.”

His heart was pounding. He looked into those amber eyes, saw them wet and shining, narrowed in sultry command.

SHE TOLD HIM AGAIN. “Max, eat my pussy. You do it so well, Max. Please...” Her fingers ran through his hair while she stared into his eyes. This last week had changed her. Changed him. Those were the familiar eyes of the woman he loved. Those were Maggie’s eyes, but something new was shining in there. Something more in control, more challenging. Even if he didn't want to go down on her, he would. She would compel him with those eyes.

But he wanted to go down on her. The thought of it now made his legs shake.

He got to his knees before her. She held the front of her skirt up over her tummy and watched him. The bald perfect thing she had between her legs was a breath away. His face moved closer. He breathed her in, felt the warmth of it on his cheek as he grew closer. She’d been dirtied. Defiled by another man. A man that was foreign to their relationship. An unknown alpha male had sexual intercourse with her.

He lightly kissed her between her legs. She pressed it forward, presented it to him. His tongue darted out, traced the soft rounded shapes of her vulva, the tip dragging along her commissure. Jay had ejaculated inside her. His semen had been spread inside her. She had been claimed. His huge

cock had launched the contents of his balls inside Maggie, then lubricated her with it, stroking in and out of her, plunging his seed deeper.

“Do it, Max,” she urged. “Do it. I need it. Show me how much you love me.” Now her hands slipped low, eased along the lines where her thighs met her hips, long, graceful fingers working through her own folds, kneading her own membranes, then spreading herself, pulling the pale flesh open to reveal her hot pink insides.

His breath clutched at the sight of her exposed like that. His dirty Maggie. Knowing what she wanted. Wanting what she wanted. Wanting something so dirty...

“Make me come, Max. I love it when you make me come...”

She moaned and her knees buckled when he took those pink folds into his mouth, grabbing up her coppery flesh and pulling it past his teeth, suckling it.

She began to sink lower down the door, moaning and gasping as he worked his tongue through her. She held the sides of his head, scratched at his scalp. She sighed his name, she made soft crying sounds. Soon she sat on the floor with her knees up, and was right down on all fours between her legs, lapping at her like a dog.

Her excitement began to rise, and she gripped his hair in tight handfuls, thrust her sex up to meet the stabbing of his tongue.

“Fuck it, Max,” she urged, “fuck me with your tongue...fuck me where he came, show me how you love me...”

His eyes shut, his hearing tuned to her words, bringing in the filthy things she said to sharp focus. Her pussy was hot and coppery. More coppery than usual. He imagined her lover shredding her sex, his large size making tiny tears in her, the copper taste the result of minute traces of damage her lover had done to her delicate membranes.

His own cock was poking into his belly, so hard, so rigid, so slippery. Maggie’s hips danced in his grip, she gyrated against his mouth. There were slick dirty slurping noises. Her breaths came short and fast. *Ah Max, ah, Max*, she chanted, still gripping his hair, still forcing his face between her legs.

“You dirty pig, Max, you dirty pig, eat it, eat all that filth, show me you love me, ah...”

Her chanting trailed off and her thighs closed on his ears. She made a low croaking groan and her tummy was trembling. Then with no warning,

he was ejaculating.

“Ah, shit,” he hissed, rose up, shoved a thumb under her skirt and pulled it high so he wouldn’t come all over the clothes she wore to travel.

“Max, ah,” she whined, her hips still grinding. Her hand came between her legs, two middle fingers bunched together, stabbing her own clit, pressing it down and working it in circles. When she saw he was coming, she put a hand out, blocking his spurts from landing on her clothes

“Max, what...?”

“Sorry,” he said, “I can’t help it.” He sprayed her bare legs with his semen, dropping long white tails on her, short, watery splashes, dots and droplets landing from her mound down to her kneecaps.

“Shit, Max,” she said in shock, sitting up and taking his cock in her hand. Her slippery touch went through his brain and short circuited him. He wobbled.

“Maxy, Maxy,” she cooed, stroking him. “My other lovers let me come first. They’re not little boys, I guess...”

“Oh fuck you, Maggie,” he chuckled.

She giggled, her grip flicking on just his glans now. “My other men know how to satisfy me. They don’t embarrass themselves...”

He took her face in his hands and kissed her fully. She breathed deeply and gave it back to him with love. They fell back naturally, man over top of woman, and her legs opened for him, her knees at his waist, her heels touching the backs of his thighs. His orgasm hadn’t waned his stiffness in the slightest and his tip found her wet stripe easily, plunged deep and made her gasp in satisfaction. She was slick and wet and so, so hot inside. She felt incredible.

He began to make love to her, laying on the cold concrete floor of some prop room. There was a bus leaving in a few minutes to take her from him but for now, he would be inside her and he would enjoy her and she would enjoy him. They kissed and worked into one another. Hands groping and moving in tender familiar patterns.

He whispered, “You were so intimate with him.”

“I like him, Max. He’s nice.”

“You looked happy with him.”

She hesitated, then said, “Max, I think he’s falling in love with me.”

“Oh,” he blurted, the intensity of carnal emotion swelling him even harder between his legs, putting terrible butterflies in his stomach that

flitted around sharply and in a darting scattered pattern that reminded him more of bats.

“He’s falling in...for you? ...”

He had trouble saying the word.

“I think he’s falling in love with me, Max.”

“Oh Maggie, oh...” he stroked in and out of her and she hugged his back and clutched her face next to his neck. “Maggie...Maggie...”

“What? ...Max...”

“Make him fall in love with you...”

“No, Max...”

“Do it. Make him love you then break his heart for me...”

She whispered, “So... Ss-so dangerous... Oh, Maxy...”

“You ever break a man’s heart?”

“I think...I broke Lee’s...”

He pinched her earlobe between his teeth and thrust deeply into her. “My bad Maggie,” he sighed.

“Say it again,” she hissed.

“Bad Maggie.”

“Mm,” she hummed, her lips pinched between her teeth, her expression tight and pained.

“Slut Maggie, whore Maggie,” he grunted with each thrust into her. She was nodding emphatically, and he repeated it. His pace quickened, he watched her beautiful face intently, wondered what images were conjured behind that beautiful brow, what dirty movies played in her mind when she was on the verge of coming.

“Like Jay’s big cock?”

“Yeah,” she gasped.

“Like big horse cocks in your tiny pussy?”

“I do...”

“Your little pussy need big fucking animal cocks? ...”

“Ah!” she cried out loudly then shoved her own knuckle in her mouth to stifle it.

They came together. The events of the day building awful things up inside them, but they were sharing, and in this damp cold dirty basement in an ancient building their secrets were combined with one another. Kept from prying eyes they could leak their darkest secrets to each other. Share their depravities, their fears, their unwanted stimulations. They were

together in the moment, doing things no one should do but they had their hooks in it, slippery as it was. Whatever it was that wriggled between them like quicksilver, as long as they both kept their hands on it it wouldn't get away. But they each needed the other to hold on tight.

Max drove deep as he watched her face twist in orgasm. She bared her teeth to him, showed him how white they were, how bright and pink and healthy her gums were. She was perfection. Physical and spiritual perfection and he loved her completely, darkness and all. Her darkness made her sweetness shine all the more brightly.

Megabus

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 5TH

HER CHEST and belly rolled up and down, a desperate whine laced her breath like an injured animal. Her neck pounded with her pulse. Max lay between her legs, the hump of his back rising and falling as quickly as her breaths. His pants were down his thighs, his cock inside her.

“Max...my bus,” she whispered.

“Yeah,” he sighed near her ear.

“That was incredible,” she told him when he didn’t rise off her. She squeezed his arms.

“You are amazing,” he said into her neck.

“Max, baby, my bus...”

His head reared up, inhaling deeply, eyes lazy and half closed. He stared into her and she smiled. He said, “Stay. Don’t go. I can’t be without you right now.”

“You know I have to.”

“You were so incredible, Maggie. I loved watching you...”

“I saw you.”

“When?”

“Behind the little pine tree.”

“That the only time?”

She nodded.

“God,” he groaned long and sighing, thumped his forehead to her chest. “I want to do it all over again. I want to do it—”

“I have to go, Max.”

“Are you my bad Maggie?” he asked her.

“You know I am,” she whispered. “Who knows what I’ll get up to on the train...or in Rhode Island. Whatever I do, I might not ever tell you.” She darted her lips to him and kissed the tip of his nose. Her words had captured his imagination. She could see it in the blank and frozen shine it had put on his glossy eyes. She laughed, said, “I’m not going to call you or text you the whole weekend. And no jerking off while I’m gone.”

“You...you jerk someone...”

“What?”

“Jerk a stranger off...on the train...”

She gasped. “Max... You want me to...?”

“Do it, you little slut. Jerk off a stranger...call me tonight...tell me...” his hips began to moil against hers and she could feel he was still hard as steel.

“You’re so hard, Max...”

“I can’t get enough of you,” he said.

She smiled, her eyes gleamed. “I’ll jerk off a stranger but I won’t call. How’s that? Picture it. Maybe he’ll like my hand so much I’ll get off at his stop and he’ll take me to his apartment and do the dirtiest things to me...”

Max’s face hovered over hers, stuck in some erotic purgatory. He hated her words, but he absolutely loved hearing them and feeling what they did to his body. She felt it too, felt his excitement, his fear, his hardness pushing between her legs, still up inside her, slippery and steely. They could fuck all day.

She said, “Maybe I’ll spend the weekend in bed with another man. I’ll learn all about what makes him hard, what makes him come. I’ll show him what I like. Show him how to touch me, how to fuck me...”

“Just your hand, Maggie,” he whispered, his eyes blank and distant.

“I don’t know. I like my idea better...”

“Don’t...”

“I’ll see you Sunday, Maxy baby. I love you. But you really have to get off me. My bus is leaving...”

He took her lips and although her anxiety was rising sharply within her—a fear building in her over missing her bus and the catastrophe that would cause at home, the confirmation it would give her parents of her low character—she loved the feel of his mouth. She ran her hands over his back and allowed herself to enjoy it for two seconds. Then she was squirming from him, flexing her tummy to eject his erection from her.

Max scrambled up, gripping his cock with one hand, closing his pants over it with the other. The muscles of her legs felt cramped and her legs were wobbly. Quite the workout this morning. Sticky bubbles tickled her between her legs and she felt his semen leaking from her. It was stomach-rolling and at the same time pulse-poundingly erotic. She would sit on a bus all the way to Boston with her men's seed seeping from her. Her nipples clenched tightly at the thought.

"What?" he asked her, catching her staring at him while he was buttoning up.

She shook her head, tried to bring reality home again. "You know what Jess wants? I have to go...I can't help you find it..."

"I have that picture on my phone. Some religious ark or something. I'll find it..."

"How do I look?" she said, twirling for him.

"Fucking incredible," he told her.

"No, seriously, Max...any telltale signs?"

"No..." he said, frowning and looking her up and down. "Your hair is messy..."

She smoothed it back, took her elastic out and redid her ponytail. "My legs, Max. Am I showing...signs? ..."

"Oh Maggie," he said, reeling at the realization of what she was asking him. He looked at her legs carefully all over and she felt strangely naked and exposed. Tightened her nipples right up again.

"Your skin went all goose bumps," he said.

"I know," she said. She crossed an arm over her chest under her poncho, "I'm still so...horny..."

He took her in his arms and kissed her again.

She whispered, "Feel my heart."

He put his hand on her chest and she said, "Feel how fast it's beating?"

"You make my heart go crazy too, Maggie. Why...why do you have to leave?"

She laughed, "I'm buying my wedding dress."

He groaned. There was no argument. They were going to be married. She needed a dress. Her mother would be waiting. You did not want to let Carol down. Max wasn't invited. This was mother and daughter as weird as that was.

“There’s no way around it, Max.”

THEY SCRAMBLED out of the prop room and trotted back the way they came. Back at the Jeep, Maggie tossed him the key to the theater. They’d spotted the ark that Jess needed, but they didn’t have time to lug it out of the prop room. He’d have to return for it.

Maggie’s luggage was simple and unpretentious, a plain black nylon bag with a few items of clothing she needed. Everything else she might need would be at home. The bag was slung over his shoulder and Maggie grew noticeably upset when she saw the time on her phone read 1 P.M.

They ran to the front of the building, up a flight of stairs, under the yellow leaves of low-hanging branches. He yelled to her it wouldn’t leave on the nose. Told her not to worry. He hated to see her upset.

When they emerged from the path and out to the front dooryard of the theater they saw the big, blue, double-decker bus closing its doors. The motor charged high diesel revs as the driver prepared to lurch out onto University Lane.

“No, no, no,” he heard her whine with panic.

Accelerating past her, he threw his body against the side of the bus and slapped at the door as frantically, but as politely, as he could. The brakes hissed, the bus jerked. When the doors scissored open, he went straight to apologies.

“Sorry, sorry, so sorry.” The bus driver’s angry face stared down, but he was disarmed. With a wave, Max also apologized to the passengers he could see peering down on him from the seats near the front.

When he turned, he saw his poor Maggie, face flushed red with worry and embarrassment, hands clasped together at her front, thin fingers looped through the handles of her luggage.

“Aww,” he couldn’t help a cooing of affection for his little girl. He waved her to him and she stepped down off the curb. Putting his arms around her, he said, “It’s okay, we made it on time. It’s okay.”

She nodded, her chin poking him in his collar. Tears were briskly wiped from her cheeks as they pulled back, and Maggie averted her eyes. He kissed her forehead. “I got you here in time. It’s okay.”

“Thanks, Maxy,” she said softly, and she kissed him under his chin.

“I wish we had more time,” he sighed. “I wish you didn’t have to leave.” Mostly though he wished they hadn’t done what they did right before she was to leave. In the sober resolve of his refractory period, he wished they had displayed more discretion. Somehow as their plan to watch her cheat came hastily, and dirtily, together there was no consideration of pragmatism. Once he had the visual in his mind of her and Jay together, pretending she was cheating, his belly, his balls, were steam driven engines being fed the fieriest coal. Once the talk had begun his lust was hurtling at breakneck speeds. Now it was done, and he was feeling some fear...not some fear, but honestly scared...that she was leaving.

Not that he didn’t trust her, just he didn’t want to be without her.

“Sorry,” she said over his shoulder, toward the driver. “We got lost, we ended up behind the building.”

Then into his ear, she said, “Maxy, I better go.”

“Okay,” he murmured, his turn now to feel red-faced, eyes welling with potential tears. “I’m going to miss you.”

“It’s just a few days,” she said weakly.

“Okay. I love you.”

“I love you too,” she said, a smile tugged at her clamped and worried mouth.

They kissed one more time and he let her go from his tight grip. Climbing the stairs up into the big bus he watched her bare legs work. Saw up her skirt the exact right amount to surge excited life back into his tortured penis. A sudden, strong urge to jerk off in the Jeep hit him, but he’d told her he wouldn’t do that.

Then she was up, wiggling her fingers to him in a timid wave and the driver shut the doors between them. The motor roared, dust kicked up from under it, and he watched the behemoth lumber out to the road, signal left, merge onto University Lane.

He waved and smiled, but the windows were tinted jet black and he couldn’t see a soul inside.

SOMEWHERE NEAR SATANS KINGDOM, the bus snaking the 63 alongside the Connecticut River, she began to relax, and the tightness that had gripped her began to loosen.

While it was hot, what they had done worked away at her as she sat watching Vermont's countryside pass by the glazed windows. When hatching this plot with Max, the idea that she would have to sit in public with her 'dirtied snatch' made her wild inside. Now she was doing it. The reality was not sexy.

She was sitting in a reserved seat, on the bus's upper deck, facing two strangers, another one at her left. A narrow rubber table with cup holders stood between them on two tall aluminum legs. The man sitting next to her was middle-aged, buttoned-up, woven leather belt with his cellphone holster clipped to it. He was a dad. Across from her, on the left, was a woman who would be someone's grandmother. Head kept down, she read a Danielle Steele novel so dog-eared Maggie was convinced she had bought it at a garage sale. Every once in a while her eyes would dart up and look at her over her wire-rimmed glasses and they would smile. Directly across from her was a guy about her age, heavysset, wearing all black despite the sunny weather. Tinny music bashed from his headphones while he read a Superboy comic. Every once in a while their feet would touch.

This morning she had sex with two different men. Both of them had ejaculated inside her. One of them had ejaculated twice. Inside her, and also all over her thighs and knees. The idea that she'd been sprayed with so much semen had begun to turn her stomach a little, and being in proximity with these relatively innocent and upstanding citizens had worked a nauseous bolus up from the acid of her stomach, higher and higher til it was wedged very close to her esophagus, somewhere near her collarbone.

Playing at her neck, her fingertips grazed along, trying to ease away some of the discomfort. Occasionally, a tingling, green wave washed over her. Her neck would go hot and wet and she thought she would have to go to the bathroom and vomit.

Every time one of them looked at her she recoiled. So frightened they would see her filth. Or her lovers' filth. Some evidence of the absolutely, terrifyingly, dirty things she'd done this morning. Her legs were clamped so tightly together that even in the cool climate-controlled air of the bus she was hot and clammy, every slight movement reminding her with a waft of fresh cold air on the dampness the tight seal had created.

It was somewhere after the Massachusetts border, before Satans Kingdom, she couldn't take it anymore. She excused herself (not that any of the passengers she sat with cared), and went to the bathroom. Her reflection was ghastly. Instead of feeling sad and sick, feeling tragic and shameful, she chuckled. Brightened at watching her face smiling, the smile went wider. It wasn't that bad. It wasn't that bad at all. The things they did, they did by will. Everyone wanted it. Everyone was in on it. Except for Jay, she supposed. Though he got what he wanted. Didn't know he was being watched, but he got what he wanted. Boy, those things he said...

She balled up wads of rough brown paper, wet it with soap and scrubbed her legs, wiped at her folds gently. Took more paper, dried herself, dried her sex very well. Laughed at the funny faces she was making as she scrubbed, bent to the side with her hand stuffed up under her skirt. Having fun with it chased some of the sickness away and by the time she returned to her seat that lump in her throat that had threatened to launch her breakfast up and out of her crying mouth had disappeared. The sun was shining, she felt physically satisfied. She did homework.

Transit

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 5TH

USING the keys Jesse had given Maggie, he let himself back into the theater, worked his way across the stage, went along to the prop room.

The fluorescent light buzzed overhead still, the flicker gone with the lights warm. Looking down at the spot where he and Maggie had sex he gave a little laugh. Right at the doorway. Room full of props to fuck on, they couldn't wait, did it right up against the door they'd closed behind them.

In the prop room, there were all sorts of things that had been built for performances through the years. Near the back sat a box the size of a steamer trunk. It had handles on both ends, long wooden poles that reached out from the sides. It was supposed to be the Ark of the Covenant or something; vaguely holy looking, with gilded edges and drawn symbols. It was light, only made to look heavy. Still, with the long poles that sprouted from either end, the thing proved awkward to get down the hall once he passed the stage. Got it there without breaking it, stuffed it in the Jeep, but had to pull the roof back for it to fit. Jesse was lucky it was a nice day.

A funny warmth spread through him as he inched through university traffic, making him heavy, sinking him into the Jeep's bouncy bucket seat. A warm satisfaction. Sore from his workout, but rewarded with some muscular tightness, sexually charged and simultaneously drained. Satiated maybe. Satiated and yet hungry for his next meal. Sunglasses on, top down on the Jeep, he eyed girls as they walked along the paths by the roadside. So many young hot girls and yet, in his first year, he'd found the gem. Long legs in jeans, skirts, shorts even on this warm fall day. He'd got his share in

high school. The girls were fun to look at and a good chunk of them might be half-decent in bed.

Young Max Milton however, one fine fall evening almost three years ago, met a beautiful, bubbly, Asian girl, and it was frankly love at first sight. In his first two months at Farmingham he'd only had sex with one college girl but after he met Maggie, he didn't want anyone else. She was smart, talented, demure yet uninhibited in bed, she was kind, she was wealthy. Now it turned out she was as dark as he was, as into the things that he would never have asked for in his life as he was. Her sexual gifts to him were enormous. None of the girls on the street could hold a match to his fiancée. All she'd needed was a gentle pushing.

It was out of Brattleboro, somewhere an hour down the densely forested road into the mountains that his warmth was washed out by a cold dread. Working over all that happened during their morning his heart began to race. Not in a good way. The tips of his fingers tingled and his breaths came fast like he was hyperventilating. There were no cars around so he pulled to the gravel shoulder and stopped. He gripped the wheel, focused his mind on what the panic was. He was awash with shame and regret...and something else. It was the something else that was driving his heart faster and faster.

Fear. It was fear he had.

"Shit, Maggie," he hissed into the Jeep. Shit. He'd told her to jerk off a stranger. Dirty talk. Dirty talk when his cock was hard and inside her and he was filled with bubbling lust at the awful thing they had done together. Now in the daylight, sitting alone without her, he was panicking. He didn't want that. It was a sexy thought, but he didn't *really* want that. She had to know. She knew it was dirty talk, right?

But did she? What were the rules these days Maxy-boy? You let her fuck the hottest guy on the planet. Let her fuck your panty-melting best friend. Those were things that should just be dirty talk. But they were bitter reality now.

A truck loaded with timber roared by and buffeted the Jeep, the interior swirling with dust and grit. The freight train sound jangled his nerves, made his heart pound even more furiously.

With the radio not working he had his phone tucked into the cup holder and one earbud stuck in an ear. Yanking it out, he gathered up his phone and shot her off a text. He waited but no reply came. He sent another.

She knew better. She wouldn't do that. Maggie was no slut, not for real.

Not til you came along, Max.

He put the Jeep back in first, let it out and rolled back onto the Number 9, headed for Farmingham.

NOT FAR FROM the city she woke from a dreamy nap. The view outside of the window had changed from lush greenery to brick-faced Boston outskirts. Looking around groggily she saw not much had changed with her compatriots. The grandmother across from her was further into her book, the dad typed away on an old Thinkpad, the guy from comicon was finished his Superboy and now he sat listening to his music with his arms crossed.

Her mouth was dry, so she licked her lips. She had drooled it would seem, and she wiped at her chin. Superboy gazed absently downward, and she followed to see her bare legs. The skirt had ridden up while she slumped sleepily and the hem slipped above mid-thigh. Squirming back with haste, her eyes went wide at the thought that her sex could have been revealed. It was very close.

It should be arousing—if she and Max were dirty-talking she would have been excited at the prospect. Two things: maybe she needed Max present as a witness, or perhaps she needed a more provocative voyeur. This guy with his wispy mustache, while not reprehensible, did not set her on fire.

Her iPad sat on the table, face up, screen blank, but she did not remember putting it there. Last thing she remembered she was studying, reading about Toulouse-Lautrec, the next she's waking with her pussy almost bared and drool coming out of her mouth. How the mighty have fallen. She retrieved the iPad, brought it to life, saw messages from her Max.

Max: Don't do it, Maggie. You know that was dirty talk.

Don't do what? What was he talking about?

Max: Maggie. Seriously.

She looked out the window, frowning, trying to imagine what he was freaked out about. It hit her.

Jerk off a stranger, Maggie.

As if she would do that. Her Max was freaking out now, and it was pretty amusing. Half an hour after those two texts he had texted again.

Max: Okay. You're being funny. ha ha

This one made her laugh silently, hard enough that her shoulders began to shake. It would be so easy to respond with, *Ha ha, get real! Or, I know, I love you, miss you already, Maxy!* Instead, with a wicked smile, she slipped her iPad into her black bag under her seat and watched the city go by. They were almost at the train station.

SHE BOUGHT a Summer's Eve douche at the South Station drugstore in Boston. What had her life become?

Then, in another effort to salvage some of her dignity, she slipped into the ladies room before her train arrived and put some goddamn panties on. But on the platform, while waiting for the train to Rhode Island, she saw a hunk.

He wore a suit in Glen plaid, shining caramel brogues, a real live flower in his lapel. He had tanned skin and a young, rugged face; his hair was perfect, short back and sides, top combed back, thick and wavy, chestnut brown with blonde highlights from the sun. He stood reading a New York Times held in one hand, a leather briefcase that matched his shoes in the other. The kind of young man every woman on this platform was giving furtive looks.

Checking her messages on her phone—pretending to—she snapped a picture of him.

Now she texted Max.

Maggie: Come on, Max. Don't back out. It's so hot. Imagine it

She tucked her phone in her pocket, laughing to herself.

She caught the hunk's eye now, and he looked her up and down, smiled and nodded. A little thrill whipped through her.

Now, were she to wake and find him staring at her accidentally exposed vagina the effect would definitely be different. What would that have been like? *Deathly embarrassing, Maggie, be honest.* Truth was, had she woken, saw him staring at her between her legs she would have been mortified. He was almost too sexy.

What if he smiled and nodded after he'd seen her pussy? Hmmm? That was interesting. Suppose she was embarrassed and yet he consoled her. God, maybe he would hold her gaze while he reached over and one of those masculine, tanned hands gently lowered her skirt so it sat where a lady's skirt should sit. Her hand went to her mouth to cover her ridiculous smile, and she shied away from the hunk.

When the train arrived she purposely got herself into a different car.

NEVER IN HER life had she a one-night stand. Or a tryst. Never had sex with a stranger. That was something that hadn't interested her. Other girls had talked about it. Not to her, but it was something she couldn't escape overhearing. The idea of being with a stranger was scary. That handsome man on the platform was drop-dead gorgeous, but what if he was a weirdo? Didn't look like a weirdo, did he? Nope. He looked smart and successful, like he knew what he was doing in the boardroom and the bedroom. Like he might discipline her, make her bend to his sexual will.

If he had sat next to her on this train what would have happened? If he had sat himself down on the outside aisle, instead of this over-perfumed white woman who had barely looked up from her phone when Maggie had said Hi, what would transpire? How does one transform a mutual eye contact and recognized mutual admiration into having sex? She supposed she would chat with him. He would be charming, totally wanting to have sex with her. Then what? Something magical but very atavistic would flash in both their eyes...?

Where would you go on an Amtrak? The washroom? Very gross. As hot as that guy was, having sex with him in a stinking train bathroom, one

coming out of fucking Boston, was highly disgusting. What then? Would they touch each other while they both sat facing the same sightless direction? He could take off his suit jacket, lay it in his lap, she could take her poncho, lay it in hers. Their hands would explore. Her fingers would find the shape of his cock in his pants, trace it with her fingers.

Would they be kissing? That would attract too much attention, draw eyes to the movement of their hands under their camouflage. They would stare into one another, laugh and smile, make lustful narrowed eyes. She would take off her panties, do that in the bathroom, let her legs part for his male-model hand. He would put a finger inside her oh-so-slowly, watching her intently as he did to feed off her expression. She would sigh. The zipper of his pants would be drawn down, his cock would come out. It would be big, of course. Mildly aroused but still lazy enough to flop against his thigh. Jay's cock was amazing to watch when it was flaccid. The way it had weight, the way it would flop, dangle, swing... Hadn't seen Cole's yet when it wasn't hard. Her hunk would have one like Jay but his would be white...mmm, yes—uncircumcised like her Cole's too. She decided that she liked foreskins. Yes, they were gross but maybe sex was better when it was just a little gross, a little mucousy, a little biological.

This could really happen, couldn't it? Her hunk would go for it, she thought. No longer timid Maggie, overwhelmed by men, she understood her value in other men's eyes. If she had given the hunk a knowing nod, she may be engaged right now in sex with him. Maybe, like she had teased Max, in the hunk's apartment. Or a hotel room.

For now, she thought of them side-by-side, hands on each other's slippery warm parts they kept hidden all day but tingled with eager life. Giving each other the joy of touch. She would grip his wrist with one of her hands, feel the tendons at work under his skin as he fingered her. Her hand would bump the sharp edges of his Rolex (worn on the improper wrist for the purposes of her fantasy), a symbol of his success because he is that type of man. Not some gold and diamond one because he didn't have a small dick. She knew that for sure; it was huge in her hand. No, he had nothing to prove. His was steel, no-nonsense, perhaps vintage, some incredible value hidden in its history that he would tell you about some time when you lay in bed in his apartment after making amazing love all night, the sun streaming through the windows of his Seaport loft...

Wow. Holy shit, Margaret. You had anal sex with Cole last night. Say it with me: That. Was. Sex. Then You let him pretend to be inside you while he had made love with both your hands until he ejaculated. Then you had wild dirty-talk sex with Max last night. Sex with Jay this morning. In public, *en plein air*, as they say. Then, with your fiancé, you had more dirty-talk, mentally and physically powerful sex.

Sex, sex, sex.

Maybe, now just maybe, Maggie, you might want to put into focus the purpose of this weekend rather than the diversion you and your filthy fiancé cooked up this morning...

But her hunk hadn't made her come yet, and she wanted him to.

Mm, he had her close. The rhythmic jostling, the *clacka-clacka* rocking her bottom in her padded seat. Her brand new panties had been dampened, she could feel that for sure.

Would she look him in the eye when she came? Was that too aggressive? Maybe that would freak him out. He would think of her as that weird Chinese girl on the train who watched his eyes while she came on his finger. Or maybe, the other way, he would always remember that hot, vaguely Asian girl who looked in his eyes as she came on his finger. That was good. Mm-hmm, he would always remember her; maybe he would always wish that he'd got her number. Her tummy fluttered, her breath shaky from her nostrils.

His cock was in her hand. He was hard, steely hard. She used his foreskin, blipping it up and down over his glans. Was he as big as Jay? ...Cole? Yes, let's just say he has Cole's cock. That she could work with.

Under his Glen plaid jacket there would be the slightest movement, a brief syncopated tenting of the fabric as her grip gave him pleasure. They would come together, watching each other. Where would he come? Surely not inside that finely tailored jacket. Maybe she had two hands under there and one would cup his seed. What if it shot out forcefully? Sometimes it did. Collecting it in the hollow of her palm wasn't foolproof. Perhaps a condom. Maybe he stretched one down on it... Not very sexy though, was it? A sock. Guys jerk off into socks, right? She'd heard that alluded to. She wasn't wearing socks. His socks? Mm, also not sexy. What if he didn't have nice feet? It was a fantasy, Maggie... He has nice feet. She didn't want to see his feet.

Your panties, Margaret.

“Oh,” she gasped out loud, just a gentle whisper, drowned by the sounds of the train.

Yes, the very panties you removed in the washroom. Oh, that was brilliant. She liked it, he would like it. Her pink panties...no, for the fantasy’s sake they were silk...no, satin, satin panties...black with lace trim, very expensive and finely made. Yes, they were wrapped around him but her hand was underneath so she could feel the heat of his manhood, feel the gummy skin.

Now her hands were clutching the arm rests. Eyes clamped shut, she flexed and wriggled her bottom in the seat.

They would orgasm together. It was in his control. He was the kind of man who could control your orgasm. She would watch his eyes, waiting for him to tell her he was ready and then he would send her off like a rocket ship with what he did between her legs with that fine hand, the one groomed and manicured to a masculine polish at Barbershop Lounge. He would know he was close and when it was time he would summon her orgasm from her, curling his finger, wagging it, telling that naughty little pleasure to get over here and lick his thousand dollar shoes.

When she came, he would too, both of them clenching their stomachs tightly, swallowing the grunts and exclamations that wanted to burst from them; she would feel the pulsing of his semen tugging at the panties in her grip, he would feel her woman parts grip his finger so tightly (that night he would masturbate, fantasizing how tight she would have been, cursing that they hadn’t fucked; Christ, what was her name!), she would feel him go rigid in her hand, feel the underside of his magnificent cock flexing as the fluid pumped out of him. It would be hot and wet in her hand, streaming over her knuckles, and she would have to bite her tongue because the pleasure he masterfully stroked from her wanted to consume her, wanted to...

The slipperiest orgasm tickled through her. A real life one. Seized her up and made her whole body tingle like she’d been on the verge of sneezing and had it interrupted. Her mouth fell open, and she curled forward slightly, squashing her pussy with her clamped thighs. She strangled the sound that wanted to come from her. She crushed the vinyl armrests in her grip, then one hand shot to cover her mouth. The white woman watched her disinterestedly, went back to her phone.

Slowly it relaxed and her muscles released. She sank into the chair and felt like she was in heaven and someone had cranked the heater. She had just made herself come with her mind. No man touched her. She hadn't touched herself. She was breathless.

Settling sleepily now into the cushioned chair, her head gently rocked back and forth with the motion of the train. The blurred green shapes of tree tops rushed past the window, beyond, in the distance, lay the spread of industrial Boston, gray and dismal and yet burgeoning with activity and development.

Her heart beat strongly, it's thudding coming slowly into her eardrums. She felt incredible. She shouldn't feel so incredible, should she? Or maybe she shouldn't feel so guilty for feeling incredible.

Perhaps her sexuality was getting out of hand. Crazy as that time when she was a teenager, and she thought she might go mad if she didn't feel the touch of a man. Accepted oddball Lee as her first lover she was so wild. Yes, she was like that now but not from abstinence. Like it now, but engaged in the obverse. Up to her B-cups in extreme hyper-sexuality. Something might be wrong with her. Perhaps a CAT scan would show a large tumor (don't worry, Miss Becker, the lab says it's benign) that pressed on her pituitary or whatever turned you, made a young girl pump her horny chemicals...

Her eyes grew heavy, and with that she drifted off again, this time in a sleep made fitful by bizarre sexual escapades and bad behavior, the whole while Max watched her, shocked but aroused...

OUTSIDE WICKFORD JUNCTION, groggy after emerging from a fitful sleep, she took her phone up, looked at the screen again, read more texts from Max. She responded.

Maggie: cute stockbroker took me to lunch in Boston. Didn't jerk him off yet, but he did kiss my cheek. Really nice lips

Maggie: Very soft lips. Things go well, I might have to get a different train

Maggie: If my parents call you just say I missed the bus in Vermont

Maggie: Aaaggh!! I'm not supposed to be talking to you dammit, this is just so exciting!!!

Now she scrolled through her film roll, found the picture of her dreamy hunk, drew a heart around him with her finger, fired it off to her fiancé. She put the phone back in her purse and smiled, watched out the window as she could see the rebuilt train station coming into view, its tall clock tower side heliographing fall sunlight from its small square windows.

From her bag she heard her phone ding—didn't even check it. A wicked smile bubbled to the surface, imagining all the worried things Max might have texted back, laughing to herself how crazy she might make him.

Switchboard

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 5TH

WHEN SHE'D ARRIVED home by limo, the service picking her up out front of Wickford Junction, her mother was still at work. Father was in Norway, his plane was coming home on Saturday, and she was alone. There had been a note on the high island counter in the kitchen. Written in her mother's odd, tight and back slanting hand, it had read:

YOUR DINNER WILL ARRIVE AT 6 P.M. I WILL BE HOME LATE. IT'S A PERFECT TIME FOR YOU TO STUDY. IF I AM NOT HOME BEFORE 10 P.M., REMEMBER THAT YOU HAVE APPOINTMENTS TOMORROW.

That left a lot up in the air. What appointments? They were finding her dress on Saturday, tomorrow was Friday. Wouldn't her mother be at work? She came home a day earlier than the dress fitting, yet her father was away on business...

A little before six, dinner had been delivered. A young woman in white uniform brought to the kitchen door a zippered bag. She'd let her in and the young chef arranged steaming containers on the counter for her. Rice with coconut and lime, organic farm fresh chicken, grilled sea bass with almonds oranges and basil. Everything perfectly cooked and perfectly nutritious, just as she had imagined her mother had instructed.

The chef was that cool kind of girl, hefty in size but with a winning smile and effortless cheer. Her face was pretty and she had lots of earrings laced up her auricle and a tantric symbol tattooed on her neck below her ear. Told her she was private chef at the Schlesinger's home, longtime neighbors

of theirs. Klaus Schlesinger a former associate of her father's, working at the same firm when they first came here from Holland. She was chatty and Maggie would have talked longer but she hadn't had a shower yet and she was hungry. The chef left her to eat, getting in a Pontiac Vibe and beeping twice as she left. Maggie closed the gate behind her using the control panel by the fridge.

Max called while she ate and worked on finishing her book on Toulouse-Lautrec. She didn't answer; laughed out loud at how mean she was being. It made her stomach tighten and tingle—with mirth and good humor, not meanness. The meanness was manufactured fun. In her mind she pictured him in his dorm room, trying to keep his chagrin from roommate Steve, telling himself that of course his fiancé didn't have sex with a stranger on the train or, God, the bus. But there would be part of him that was thinking *Shit, what if she did?* That part of him, and she was becoming very aware of it, was kind of fun. Not answering her phone was her gift to him. She was feeding that little gollum that lived in the swampy, moss-slick parts of his brain, worrying a tarnish on a metal band of sick jealousy.

Providing nourishment to that weird part of him was his reward for his allowances regarding her sexual proclivity. Growing sexual proclivity. What other man than Max would allow her to pursue the things she had missed while she had already promised herself to him? Now, he got something from it too, but she didn't mind that their darkness was symbiotic. Maybe it was some knowing glimmer they saw in each other's eyes from the very beginning that told them they were two of a kind. And it just took them a few years for their stinking flower to gather up the necessary nutrients and minerals from the soil of their loving relationship before opening up to the light.

Three times Max called. It began to worry her that he was calling about something serious but then her phone dinged with a text message.

Max: you got home okay, right?

She laughed out loud at that. Picturing him now like an admonished child. Worried that his mommy was dissatisfied with his behavior, looking

for her favor. Coming up with a text that would better encourage a response from her other than his sexual worry.

She texted.

Maggie: what a day!

She waited.

Max: I know. You home?

She smiled. Laying on her bed, freshly showered, scrubbed, and lemony-freshened with a douche, she was feeling quite good. No one was home and she lay in her room, face down on her bed, up on her elbows with books and iPad and macbook and iPhone spread around her. Wearing just a wide neck sweatshirt, panties, legs and feet bare, hair tied back in a ponytail.

Maggie: We're not supposed to be talking.

Max: I have to! I miss you!

He was happy he had her talking now.

Maggie: we shouldn't be talking...I want you going crazy...

Max: I am going crazy

Maggie: I want you to really miss me...then when I come home...you know...

Max: Oh God. You are killing me.

Maggie: I miss you

Max: I love you

She texted him back a bursting heart emoji.

Maggie: I love you too

Her legs kicked gently while she watched the screen, saw the signs he was writing something, then it would stop. Then the dots would appear again, dancing while her Max carefully worded what he wanted to know. A smile was pulling her cheeks up and she giggled and threw her head forward, waited. The dots stopped again.

This time her iPhone, iPad, and macbook all chimed in unison. A tab scrolled down on her phone but moved away before she could read it. Tilting her iPad screen, she read:

Jay: You make it home okay?

She chuckled and licked her lips. To Jay she texted:

Maggie: Chilling in RI, all in one piece!

With a wide smile she rolled over on to her back, put her iPad on her stomach and brought her knees up. While she waited, her iPhone chimed and she held it in her palm and read:

Max: I assume you were kidding about your traveling partner

Maggie: why?

Max: seriously, maggie

Maggie: what?

Max: were you serious?

Maggie: you told me to

Max: dirty talk, you know that

Maggie: no I don't

Max: so you did?

Maggie: yeah. I wouldn't have, I wasn't looking. That guy found me and you told me to. Literally told me to

Max: ok

A laugh escaped her, loud in her still room, and she pictured his cute face twisted in frustration.

Maggie: are u mad?

Max: no

Maggie: I thought it was ok

Max: I guess it is

She stifled a laugh, snorting into her clenched palm, like she was worried he would overhear her. Her hand came away and she enjoyed a loud laugh.

Maggie: sorry

Max: it's ok. What happened?

Maggie: I don't know. Cheer up, maxy, I'll tell you everything when I get home

Max: please tell me now

Maggie: not much happened, okay?

Max: then tell me...

Now her devices chimed again and she tilted the iPad leaning on her thighs, angling a glare away from the screen so she could read:

Jay: Glad ur ok. Lot of weirdos on the trains

Maggie: Never mind the buses...I heard a guy got his head cut off one time while he was sleeping.

Jay: Maybe I should have gone with you

Maggie: Keep me safe or meet my parents?

Jay: ha ha. We there yet?

Maggie: Not even close. They love Max. I love Max.

Jay: Okay. I love our time together. You regret what we did?

Maggie: I'm okay with it. I know what it is. You know what it is?

Jay: I know what it feels like

Maggie: Tell me what it feels like

Jay: Ha ha no way. You tell me first

Maggie: Feels like sex

Jay: If you say so.

Maggie: I say so

Jay: good sex?

Maggie: uuuhhh, what do you think?

Jay: is it conceited to say I think I make you see stars and rainbows

Maggie: pretty conceited. what about unicorns?

Jay: shiiit, you see unicorns? That's some next level shit...

Maggie: it is indeed

And with that she added an eggplant emoji. Now she was one of those girls. The naughtiness was thrilling.

Then there was another melody of incongruous chimes as all of her devices dinged a new arrival. There was a third player vying for her

attention. She laughed out loud, ran her hands over her hair and gripped her neck.

Cole: U get home safe?

She swished her mouth from side to side, texted.

Maggie: made it in one piece!

Cole: good. I like you in one piece

Maggie: me too. Two pieces or more would be terrible

Cole: and painful. How's Carol and Martin

Maggie: absent

Cole: my little Maggie is all alone in her big house?

Maggie: OMG and it's dark outside

Cole: you scurred?

Maggie: so scurred

While texting Cole her phone had binged three times. Holding it up she read three texts from Max.

Max: Maggie?

Max: hello?

Max: just tell me

Her thumbs moved on their own, a wide smile on her face.

Maggie: are u mad? I don't want you to be mad

Max: no. Tell me

Maggie: we kissed a bit

Max: kissed?

*Maggie: yeah, he sat next to me. He started it. He came on to me.
Can I just tell u later?*

Max: call me

Maggie: no.

There was a long pause and she watched three dots bobbing around while Max struggled with this entirely false information she was meanly feeding him. Her toes wiggled and she sucked on her lower lip while she waited. Finally, he responded.

Max: did he touch you?

Maggie: he put his hand up my skirt but I stopped him

Max: ok

Maggie: you and Jay left me really dirty down there. What would he have thought if he touched me, ha ha

Max: did u touch him?

Maggie: u know I bought a douche at the train station. Almost twenty-one yo and I never douched in my life

Max: did you touch him?

Maggie: yeah

Max: did you?

Maggie: yes

Fearing she would lose her gullible little boy she scaled it back.

Maggie: only through his suit

Max: ok

Maggie: sorry

Max: was he hard?

Maggie: yeah

Max: what else?

Maggie: nothing

Max: nothing?

Maggie: no.

Max: you didn't make him...

Maggie: no. It wasn't very sexy really. Too many ppl around

The thought of her hand moving on her hunk under his Glen plaid jacket was at once comical and also, admittedly, kind of arousing. You would never get away with it, would you? She supposed if you were highly motivated you could do it. But would it be sexy with a stranger?

On her macbook she saw a message from Cole left hanging.

Cole: the calls are coming from inside the house Margaret

She texted him back.

Maggie: you trying to creep me out?

Cole: I'm waiting for you to beg me to come keep you safe

Maggie: fun but too much to do. Appointment with Carol tomorrow, dress on sat

Cole: I don't like u being away

Maggie: it sucks. bored

Tilting her iPad she saw that Jay had texted under her eggplant emoji.

Jay: eggplant? that's what you think it looks like?

Maggie: ha ha, do you think I have an exact emoji? that's the closest they got...I work with what I'm given

Jay: ha ha, me too

Maggie: touche

She looked around her room, smirking, reluctant to type what she wanted to. She did anyway.

Maggie: send me one

Jay: one what?

Maggie: you know

Jay: we talking about what I think we're talking about, or maybe you got me so all I think about is sex.

Maggie: Tit for tat. send me one

Jay: don't you have a drawing?

Maggie: mm, left it at home tho

Jay: lol hold on

She watched her iPad screen expectantly, her mouth working around nervously. Picked up her phone and read from Max:

Max: did you get his number?

Maggie: yeah he put it in my phone but I didn't give him mine

Max: thank God. Why not?

Maggie: thank God? I don't know why not. He was so hot. I mean really hot

Max: thanks

Maggie: you saw him

Max: big dick too?

Maggie: yeah pretty big. Like Cole but maybe not quite as thick

Max: that's nice

Now she had to cup her hand over her mouth again, stifling an urgent laugh that brought tears to her eyes from restraining it.

Maggie: I think I like girth. Jay hurts sometimes when he goes deep. He bumps my cervix and it makes me feel queasy

Max: okay

Now she hooted and kicked her feet.

Maggie: I think Cole could hit my cervix if he tried but he wants to be careful I think. he's a gentle lover

Max: Jay can't help it? He's just soooo big?

Maggie: I don't know. Cole stretches me and I like that

Max: I don't want to hear about it

Her head cocked in sad affection. Max did want to hear about it, she figured. Maybe this was too mean though, maybe this would be something she could say when they were together and he would enjoy it.

Maggie: sorry. I'll shut up

Max: how're your parents?

Maggie: not even home. Haven't seen them.

Max: you could have stayed with me. Gone tomorrow.

Maggie: yeah. Too late now

Max: I miss you so much

Maggie: I didn't kiss anybody on the train shithead.

As much as she'd enjoyed twisting her Max up like that, it felt so wonderful to let him off the hook. She ran her thumb over the edges of her iPhone and imagined him falling off his dorm room bed with relief.

On her macbook Cole had texted:

Cole: u hinting u want company?

Maggie: no way. Supposed to be only me and Carol this weekend

Cole: I know so much about wedding dresses tho

Maggie: Weird, u look like u know nothing about wedding dresses

Cole: looks can be deceiving Mags

Maggie: what are u doing this weekend?

Cole: pining

Maggie: didn't take u for such a sap

Cole: u don't know what pining is

Maggie: I don't?

Cole: it's dirty

Maggie: ha ha it is not

Cole: I make everything dirty

Maggie: now that I believe

Cole: thank you. I'm going to pine the shit out of some freckle-face freshman

Maggie: don't worry I won't ruin ur reputation

Cole: I don't want my fans to be disappointed

Maggie: all those teen girls

Cole: I know my market

Maggie: gross

Cole: Nah my dick is taking a break

Maggie: Aw, don't let it get out of shape

Cole: u corralling me into an 'exercise' joke?

Maggie: like what?

Cole: like I'll spend the weekend masturbating

Maggie: that what ur gonna do?

Cole: I'll be thinking of you lol

Her stomach flinched, then fluttered. Chewed her lip again, her thumbs feeling a little sweaty she slowly typed:

Maggie: mm kind of hot, send a pic

Cole: wait of me masturbating?

Maggie: no

Cole: whew thought you'd gone hardcore perv

Maggie: no you didn't, you hoped that's what I meant

Cole: no comment

Maggie: just send me a regular pic

The room was quiet as she waited. The ding from her iPad startled her and she tilted it to reveal a photo Jay had sent. His viewpoint, looking down between his legs. That huge thing he had was half-aroused, lurching to one side, the swollen glans touching down on his muscular leg. It was dark against his caramel thighs and her stomach fluttered again, that stretch that lay between her anus and her vagina tightened like a string on her cello.

Her phone dinged now with a message from Max but her eyes stayed on the image of Jay's large penis.

Then below it, a text from Jay followed.

Jay: I'll be in Farm on Thursday

Maggie: Okay

Jay: u want to see me?

Maggie: I'm done figure drawing

Jay: you're so cold

Maggie: I'm heartless

Jay: See me Maggie. no strings

Maggie: txt me Wed

Jay: can't wait. Take care

Her phone chimed again with another message from her Max but now she saw that Cole had sent a photo. She enlarged it.

Artfully shot, careful light played along the surface of his very thick uncircumcised club. He'd eased his foreskin back so it bunched in creases under the flare of his glans, showing off its plump shape. He was achingly erect. She frowned.

Max texted again but she texted Cole.

Maggie: how did you get so hard so fast?

Cole: I'm always hard for you baby

Maggie: oh my God did you send me a file pic?

Cole: ha ha, yes.

Maggie: wtf? how many dick pics you send you have to have them on hand?

Cole: gotta keep these bitches happy

Maggie: ah, the life of the Lothario

Cole: the struggle is real

Maggie: send me one now. Send me one where it isn't hard, I've never seen that

Cole: few have

Maggie: ha ha, send me one. now

Cole: I don't think I should

Maggie: Why not?

Cole: I think it's wrong

Maggie: what the hell are you talking about?

Cole: I don't know

Maggie: You just sent me one!

Cole: that was on my phone already

Maggie: so?

Cole: taking one just for you is stepping over a line

Maggie: ??? you forget last night? crisis of conscience?

Cole: crisis of conscience

Maggie: wow. Cole is deep

Cole: Cole misses you.

Maggie: I'll be back on Sunday

Cole: we should all go out

Maggie: I'd like that

Cole: ok ttyl pick a good dress

Maggie: see you

Staring at the painting she'd done when she was in high school, she realized her mouth had fallen open. She huffed, closed it. Shrugged. That wild painting, hanging high on the concrete wall that faced the foot of her bed, was done when she was seventeen, meant something then, a lot about being dissatisfied and being unfulfilled. She'd never admit that it was sexual in nature. Maybe others could read it because it had done her well. It one three awards at local galleries and exhibitions, and had been a major piece of her portfolio in her Farmingham package. Three years later and look at her now.

She stared dumbly at the words Max had been texting her.

Max: Maggie?

Max: Maggie

Max: are you kidding?

She typed.

Maggie: I slept on the train. That guy was in a completely different car

Max: You are a fcuking butch and I hate your stupid guts

Maggie: I hope u mean bitch

Max: I do. I'm so mad I can't type

Maggie: guy was hot though right?

Max: I guess

Maggie: If he did sit next to me, who knows?

Max: so nothing happened? You were kidding?

Maggie: yes. But not about the douche

Max: I don't know if that's gross or hot

Maggie: I know right?

Max: maybe kind of both. Bad girl

Maggie: would you believe me if I told you I can literally feel waves of ur relief all the way here in RI

Max: I believe you. You had me almost crying

Maggie: I'm going to have you eating out of my hand

Max: I'd do anything for you

Now she was smiling again; smiling and feeling warm. She would go for the trifecta.

Maggie: send me a picture of my friend

Max: what friend?

Maggie: I bet that little man between your legs is standing at full attention from my story

Max: You want a picture?

Maggie: Am I right?

Max: yeah

Maggie: so show me

It didn't take long for her Max to produce a picture of his penis for her. Imagined he must have thrust his sweatpants down, penis hard as stone already (hopefully roommate Steve was gone!), snapped his pic and sent it with trembling hands. Of her three men he would be the most eager, the most anxious. All her time with him, the two of them secret perverts, and neither had texted images of their private parts to each other. She owed him one of what she had.

For now she surmised the picture he had sent. He was erect, fully, a telltale shimmer of semen running a line down his shaft, showing her the effect her dirty story had on her husband-to-be. Between his thin hips, his thumb pressed his cock upright; her Max laying on his back, his bushy pubes swirling the base of him, his balls tight and excited, held up close to his cock. It was arousing. All three of them were amazing things, disembodied cocks but all of them intimate partners to her, their features being delineated to her as unique and separate as the elements of her lovers' distinct personalities. The men were all unique, their equipment unique, their passions, their abilities...

Maggie: I miss him. But if you touch him I swear I won't for a month.

Max: I won't

She was startled again, this time by a long pervasive beep that seemed to exist within the walls of the house. Her mother was home. She could hear the pulses of sound as Carol's fingers danced the code out on the control pad in the kitchen, and she got a chill thinking about security systems and video cameras and the things that might have been recorded and viewed by her own father. Maybe her mother too. The two of them watching a monitor, arms folded, seeing their own daughter fucking her fiancé and their Best Man at the same time. She shivered. Even if such a video existed it would be too dark to see anything, right? Unless he had night vision. A cold ball of dread returned but she shook it off as she climbed out of bed.

Standing clutching her phone in both hands, head bowed, she signed off with her Maxy.

Maggie: gotta go, Carol just got home

Max: say hi to your mom and dad for me, don't forget

Maggie: of course. I miss you so much Max

Max: I'm dying without you

Maggie: I'll be home on Sunday. No touching remember.

Max: I know

Maggie: no texting either you bad boy

Max: no games then!

Maggie: I was asking for it wasn't I?

Max: I love you

Maggie: I love you too

She sent a bursting kiss emoji, lips pressing and smacking, threw her phone down into the bed sheets.

Standing now on the hand woven rug that lay before her dressing table and a tall mirror on an articulated stand she watched her reflection. Times sure had changed. Girl in the mirror had bare and shapely legs. Not too thin after all. Her wide-necked sweater had slipped down one arm and exposed her slim creamy shoulder, sans bra strap. Perky tits pressed up against the fabric, nipples—aroused by her lovers—poked through in undeniable humps. A hand slipped along her trim tummy, fingers dipping under the waistband of her pale pink panties, touching herself, finding her sex warm and wet and clearly aroused. A wide glossy smile stretched her lips and she winked at herself. *Look at sexy little Maggie Becker, three men on a string...*

Avowal

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 6TH

HE DIDN'T HEAR from Maggie at all on Friday and he gave her space.
That night, just at dinner, she sent a text that said:

Maggie: guess what my appointment was today

Max: no idea

Maggie: she had me play cello at a legal function

Max: how mad are u, scale 1 to 10

Maggie: 1000000000

Max: sorry

A secret piece of him laughed. Like she had deserved it for the game she played yesterday. As ridiculous as it was, as transparent really, she had played him expertly like he was her fucking cello.

It was ridiculous that she would jerk some guy off on the train, or even make out with a stranger. That wasn't Maggie. He knew her. He should have seen right through her ploy. But she towed him out to deep water and

cut the rope. Let him thrash and sputter. Just as he bragged to himself how he knew her, perhaps she knew him better. Knew how long to drag out the subterfuge, how to carefully, reluctantly reveal the small pieces of her story for maximum believability. By not talking to him she let his own brain build up a story. Saw her picture of the handsome train passenger, laughed it off as her being silly. Then radio silence. He made himself believe. Then her texts, cold and distant, detached from him...*Sure, Max, what? ...you told me to...*

That was his weakness. A cold shoulder from Maggie was like a .44 Magnum through his heart. An absence of her affection, something so slight, imaginary, implied...had scale like the Grand Canyon. Last night she got him bad. It was subtle. *He came on to me.* That's how it could happen. *He was gorgeous.* He was. *We only made out.* Believable. *You and Jay left me so messy I was embarrassed for him to touch me.* Groan. A diversion. An acute and precise manipulation like throwing a ball of yarn past the most skeptical of cats. That's when she hooked him. If she was meaner, she could have him believing it still.

So, good. Good. I hope you had to play your cello for four hours and the room wasn't air conditioned. How you like that?

Not really. He'd like to say it to her but if she was in another playful mood who knows what she would convince him of next. The last week of their lives was already putting far too much stress on his heart. Their escapade yesterday was of mammoth proportion. It had enough nutrition to sate his sexual appetite for quite some time. Then her play last night, then getting him to send a picture of his erection. His heartbeat was a fluttering trepidation, afraid it would trip itself up into a complete heart attack. They were on a tightrope. He knew he was, and it would seem she was also riding something very sharp. Not letting him touch himself had him wound up tight. She had him in control. He wanted it. The game wouldn't be played if he didn't want to. He'd take his ball—balls—and go home. This was by his own free will.

As much as he wanted to play it all over again in his head, he wouldn't. Couldn't stop thinking about it though. Her legs wrapped around Jay, their soft talking, their kissing. Her expression. What he did together with her in the prop room. How wet she was when he fucked her. God, the dirty things she said to him. Her games too. He couldn't stop toying with the disgusting idea that his Maggie—honor student, smart and talented, sweet—had to

douche because he and Jay had filled her up with their fluids. He shuddered. His cock was iron going on hours now, straining at the cotton of his pants.

Sunday seemed too far away.

So he tried to occupy himself by catching up on all the reading he was behind on and writing a paper that he'd put off this week. The more he could clear from his plate the more time he could spend with Maggie when she got home. Maybe he would take her out and they would do something loving. He'd like that. She would too. Put a clip in the bulging toothpaste tube of their perversion, allow a little reset of sorts, a reminder that under all this new found depravity they were fundamentally a sound, loving couple who would marry in ...nine and a half months now.

WHEN COLE SHOWED up at eight, he thumped Max's door open without knocking and yelled *Max!* Scared the shit out of him and Steve. The MacBook on his lap bounced on his thighs as he flinched. Steve let out a deep, brief howl. Cole chuckled, pointed his finger at Max and said, "I'm buying you a beer."

Max said, "Dude, I already texted you. I can't, I want to—"

"Max, just give me an hour, okay? I'm buying. I swear I'll have you back in an hour. I swear. Come have a slice and a beer."

He looked down at his paper in progress, his handwritten notes on the bed. Knew his thoughts were fleeting things and worried that he might lose his slippery grip on his complicated thesis... But he said, "One hour? ..."

"One hour tops. You gotta eat..."

To Steve, Cole said, "Sorry, dude, I'll get you next time. I have important Maggie matters to discuss," and he winked.

Max, paused, half off the bed, said, "Maggie?"

"Wedding stuff," Cole said.

They went to Altieri's, and they didn't talk about Maggie. They talked about all sorts of things that made him think Cole was putting off something he wanted to say about Maggie. Then he knew what it was before Cole even said it.

After slices of pizza and a pint of beer at the bar of busy Altieri's they walked back to campus, and it was in the Oren Glen that they stopped.

Max guessed what was coming when Cole wandered around the concrete lip of the garden, watching his chukkas, hands shoved in his pockets. Max stood and waited, his hands tucked in his own pockets. Finally, he said, "This the *'Maggie matters'*? ..."

Cole nodded. He was biting the inside of his mouth. "Dude...Max, I really fucked up."

"Did you?"

"I think so..."

"What did you do?"

He ran his hand through his hair, shook it, inhaled. "Night before last...Maggie and I hung out..."

"I know."

"I think I fucked up."

"What happened?"

"What did she tell you?"

"Nothing."

He sighed, almost inaudibly, coming out as a groan. "Okay. I came on too strong. I tried something on her and I definitely shouldn't have."

"What did you try?"

"Pssh," he said, unable to look at Max now. "Everything."

"Did you do something?"

"You know how good she is. Nice, I mean. I don't have to tell you. I ran something on her I'd run on some co-ed. Not someone I know. I'm so stupid."

"So, what happened?"

"Well, nothing. I just shouldn't have done that. I like her too much. I like you too much. I'm sorry. I'm really sorry."

Max wandered around in a circle, hands still in pockets, looking at his own shoes. Made his way to the bench and sat heavily in it. "That's okay. This is all fucked up. I'm fucked up."

"Nah, don't say that. I get it. I get you. I get her."

"You don't think I'm fucked up?"

"Dude, we're all friends. It's not so crazy. I've slept with some of the same girls as some of the guys on the team. It's no big deal. Some of those guys end up really caring about those girls even though some of the other players may have been with them. It's...I don't know...no big deal. But I

mean it...I think the world of Maggie, and you...you are my best friend. I shouldn't have done what I did." He set himself down on the bench.

"She told me."

"Told you what?"

"Told me what you guys did. She wouldn't keep that from me."

"Ohh, fuuck," he said, leaning forward and putting his face in his hands, scrubbing them up and down, rubbing his eyes. "Do you think I'm an asshole?"

Max laughed, "No. I get it. We need rules, that's all."

"Rules? It's not...? I mean... You still...?"

"I think so. I think she does...still want to..."

"So fucked up," Cole sighed. "Not you, I mean me."

"Cause of what you did?"

"Yeah. I mean, part of me was serious...about wanting it to be for all our benefit. For next time. I...hoped there would be a next time."

"*Was* it for all our benefit?"

"Yeah, of—"

"No, I know your intention was for all our benefit...did it work out that way?"

"I guess. No, I know. Yes, she... God, I don't know how to say it. She learned..."

"Learned?"

"That it was okay."

Now he was lost. What was okay? What had they done that she learned?

"I meant it for all of us to be looser next time, but I shouldn't have done it. I broke a rule. We don't have rules but I know I broke a rule."

Max drew a deep breath in, let it out. "She's not mad or anything, you know."

"I know."

"You've talked to her?"

He nodded.

Max said, "When I met her later that night we had incredible sex."

Cole nodded. "That's good."

"So whatever you worked out with her, it was a benefit."

Cole didn't answer. Eyes cast down at the pavement between his shoes. Max watched him a while as he seemed to work something out in his mind.

"Do...you? ..." he trailed off.

Max said, "What?"

"Some time, do you think me and Maggie could be alone?"

"Holy shit...what?" He chuckled, brows up in bewilderment. "Why?"

"I don't know," he said, running his hands through his hair in frustration again. "I want her to have what you want her to have...I want the same thing for her. I care about her. I think...I don't want it for me...well, I do want to, but I mean...God, I mean I think she wants to..."

"Be alone? With you?"

"Max, it's not crazy. She's so sweet. She'd never ask you. You know that. She doesn't even want to ask, she won't ask. But I know she wants to. She wants to have that experience before you guys are married. To be alone... Man, I can't even say it..."

"Alone with you," he said, resting his chin in his hands, staring holes into the garden across from them. "I don't...I don't like it..."

"I know. I know," he agreed. "Fuck," he said, his hand fumbling inside the front pocket of his lacrosse sweatshirt. His phone came out, and he held it speculatively, turning it over and over between his two hands. He said, "Can I show you something?"

Afterword

Sign up for my newsletter to get the latest info, sneak peeks at upcoming stories, and even a free story or two down the road!

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Other Books by KT Morrison

MAGGIE Series

[Tempting Maggie](#)

[Sharing Maggie](#)

[Secret Maggie](#)

Exploring Maggie

Max is a fourth year Government and Policy student engaged to wed the love of his life. Maggie is a fourth year Art student and she can't wait for the summer to come so she can finally tie the knot with the guy she fell in love with when they were Freshmen. They've been together four years at their prestigious private college nestled in the Green Mountains of Vermont. This is the year they'll graduate and set out into the world together as a couple. But Maggie is surprised to find her desires set on fire by a gorgeous new figure model. She thinks she'd never cheat but she can't stop thinking about him. When Max learns her secret he's crushed. It tears down everything he knows about her. But in the rubble he finds something shining: excitement. Now, if he could just convince her it's okay...

Learning Lessons

A Losing His Wife Novel

This long series is now one novel! A 160,000 word cuckold tragedy...

Pete and Jess Mapplethorpe have been married for seven years now. They've got two wonderful little boys and an Irish Setter. Everyone that knows them would say they are the nicest couple you'd want to meet.

Well, they might say that Pete can be a bit of a jerk sometimes—but Jess? Regional Grade Three teacher of the year, three years running. Pretty, polite, sensitive, kind and thoughtful...

It must have been black magic that brought them together...

Behind closed doors everyone would be shocked at what goes on. They'd never believe the dirty things that sweet Jess might do or say. Pete doesn't think he has what it takes to please his beautiful wife and they fantasize about larger men taking her and making her happy.

She's just starting to discover herself at thirty-five... She wants to make up for lost time. They've found a handsome, well-built young man to play along. It's better than they even imagined. Now that they've started will she be able to stop? What if she doesn't want to?

Her husband loves enduring distressing levels of humiliation and she's finding a crazy pleasure now in delivering it...

Losing His Wife 2 Series

[Losing His Wife 2: Box 1](#)

[Losing His Wife 2: Box 2](#)

[Losing His Wife 2: Box 3](#)

Geoff J. Kane is a successful children's book illustrator. Ten years ago he married the girl of his dreams. She'd been his best friend and he'd helped her through tough relationships and gave her his shoulder to cry on many nights. Then after two years, she kissed him. Now they're married and they've got a beautiful seven-year-old daughter.

Nia Kane was a wild one. She liked to have fun and she liked to cause trouble. Everything she did, in the end, blew up in her face, hurt her. One night she realized the best man in her life was sitting with her, telling her it was all going to be okay. She kissed him and it was wonderful and he's always good to her.

Their daughter is growing up, she's away at school now and it seems like it might be a good idea for Nia to return to the workforce. The city isn't getting any cheaper. She gets a job offer from an old friend. The brother of her very hot ex-boyfriend. She cried on her husband's shoulder a lot over this guy, back when Geoff was just her buddy.

Having her ex back in her life stirs up old feelings in both of them. They both like it. There was something exciting about that time when they were twenty. It's safe now. He's got her. They can fantasize, right?

Obsessed Series

[Obsessed: Book One](#)

[Obsessed: Book Two](#)

Four couples lives intertwine as they explore their erotic boundaries. From simple wife-watching to cuckolding and domination and humiliation, these couples have one thing in common: they all share the same incredible bull. And he is far more than they even expected.

Mike and Gretch: Not married, but dating for a good long while. Two comedy writers just at the edge of love, that strange and delicate space where the act of sharing can be so dangerous. But they're two cool cats and they're sure they've got it all locked down. They call her ex-boyfriend from college, Atticus Hawke, a guy who has in the years since their breakup, and before Mike, been a reliable booty call for her.

Sean and Courtney: Sean's a Type A stick of dynamite. A rocketing studio exec, competitive and driven, he shares an incredible bond with his gym-toned wife. Courtney is all in for the new game she and her handsome husband have devised. Their ten-year-old daughter is out of the house and away at

boarding school. They've planned a one-year commitment to one another about honesty, openness, and exploration. They're going for broke. Their new thing? Sean likes to watch and Court likes to be watched. They've found a guy online. He seems too good to be true. A guy called Finch, endowed, muscular, handsome like a fashion model. Courtney's been working out and she's going to put this stud through his paces.

Steve and Becky: Becky's a headstrong X-Ray technician who landed herself a multi-millionaire tech investor husband thirty years her senior. Steve loves to be dominated and he found the girl of his dreams in Becky. She's got an iron will and she loves her husband. Loves him enough to lock him in chastity and keep him abstinent for months on end. It's okay, don't worry about Becky, she gets a regular visit from a drop-dead gorgeous man named Finch. He keeps her satisfied. Sometimes, if he's been good, she'll even let her husband watch.

JJ and Amy: Two young country bumpkins just arrived in Los Angeles. JJ wants to live a lifestyle he's only dreamed of and this city is part of it. He's married to the sweetest little nineteen-year-old outta Jackson Pond, South Carolina and he's sure she's on a fast ticket to stardom. She just needs her first big break. While they're waiting he's got a fantasy he wants to see lived out. He would do anything to see his little Amy with a man who's got a big one, one'll make her scream like those girls he watches on the internet. He found a guy online, one Amy didn't make her vomit-face at. He's got everything JJ's been looking for and, thank the stars, he's agreed to do it.

Atticus Hawke: Finch is his online name. His nighttime name. The one he uses on a site that puts him in touch with couples looking for a bull just like him. By day he is Atticus Hawke. You might have heard of him. You know the song from the eighties, 'Going With That Girl'? No? You'd know it if you heard it. That was Atticus' dad, Ricky Hawke. Yes, that Ricky Hawke. Now you know. Made a bunch of singer-songwriter hits in a time when all the kids wanted pop coming out of synthesizers and their stars to be pretty boys and have colourful hair. Ricky had real talent. So does Atticus. One of L.A.'s hottest emerging Modern artists, his work commands a fortune. But it pales against his enormous trust fund. These days his real work is done at night. His masterpieces. That's where his passion is. Watching and participating in intense psychological dramas in dark hotel rooms across the city. He gives women what they want. They're a canvas, a medium. His audience: their husband.

The Cayman Proxy Series:

The Cayman Proxy (Box One)

Mitchell Sutton's family is one of the wealthiest in London. But Mitch is an outsider, the handsome young son who took his own path. He's in love with a girl from the wrong side of the tracks.

Kate's a troubled Council house girl thrown into a lifestyle she never imagined. But she's more than his dressed up little princess.

He's got just about everything she needs. But she's got a mind full of dark thoughts she can't escape. And there's something Mitch can't give her.

She needs something his money can't buy.

He would do anything for her.

They hit the hot beaches of Grand Cayman, a reunion with an old friend and a handsome stranger. Passion boils in her blood. Can she make this work or will her desires destroy the man she loves?

Going A Little Too Far

You couldn't picture a sweeter couple than Troy and Emma.

Troy's a former Division One college wrestler. A walking water park at two-sixty-five, with shoulders no woman could get her arms around and a set of abs you could scrub laundry on.

Emma's a sweet little Georgia Peach. Pretty as can be in her proper dresses; she's a good girl from a good family that raised her right.

You couldn't tell by looking at them that they were two straight-up freaks that loved to push each other's kinky buttons.

Emma, with all her book club shyness, loves to be man-handled, loves to be lifted off her feet and dominated. Troy is a monster with a six-hundred-fifty pound deadlift and she's like a feather in his arms.

Troy likes to be humiliated. He knows he doesn't have much 'down there' and he likes his virginal wife to tell him he's no good and she'd have to get what she wanted elsewhere.

Couple of closet freaks.

A summer housewarming party on a scorching hot West Texas day puts a gift in their lap. A big, larger-than-life playtoy for Emma to tease her husband with. He wants her to. She wants to do it. But once it starts, where do you stop? What's going too far?

Taken While He Watches: On Their Honeymoon

Ken and Ashley just got married and while money is super-tight they've got themselves a weekend getaway in the Honeymoon Suite looking out over the ocean on the sunny Carolina coast.

The room was a steal. Turns out it's Bike Week and no one books the Honeymoon Suite during Bike Week. Especially not two dopey white kids from the suburbs.

A mix-up leaves them in trouble and they don't know how they can get out of it, don't even know how they'll get home. They get some help from their hotel neighbours. A half dozen handsome, muscular, and very wealthy black men.

Ken's wary but Ash is all in.

When they find out she's saved herself for her special night she becomes the star of the show and they'll offer anything to help her...

Ken doesn't like it but she's going to do what they ask. She says it's for their future...

Taken While He Watches: At The Combine

Coralee has put her own career on hold to help her husband keep his Sports Podcast afloat. He's spent eighty grand on his tiny entertainment empire.

Bobby just needs a big break. His business is a half second away from going belly-up. When their camera captures an XXL wardrobe malfunction by the combine's star prospect they see an opportunity.

Coralee will do anything to get an interview with him. She'll use the video as leverage. She'll get to this bad boy super-athlete, even if she has to break into the locker room...

She's doing it to save the family business, right?

Taken By His Best Friends: At The Hockey Rink

Marguerite was a sexy little French student Randall fell in love with at college. She loved hockey. He played hockey.

They fell in love and they married. They live a regular 9 to 5 now, but Randall and his best friends still play once a week. They are four big guys and they play rough and Marguerite is always there to cheer them from the stands.

When they all end up alone in the locker room after a bench-clearing brawl passions are already high. And when some innocent flirting starts it quickly tumbles out of control.

Marguerite does nothing to stop it. Randall is frozen...

He's going to watch his best friends do all the dirty things they've ever dreamed of doing to his wife...

Measured Next To Her Ex: A Medical Size Comparison Cuckold Fantasy

When Ben Watson went to the new Sexual Performance Clinic across from his office he was just looking to get some help.

But when he showed up on Opening Day the place was so overwhelmed they started doubling up in exam rooms to make sure all the patients were assessed.

Of all the gin joints in all the—

Guess who his exam partner is? Yeah, his honey-pie's ex-boyfriend. He is going to be sitting next to him, knees practically touching, while these nurses assess their size and performance using only their latex hands.

He could leave, get the hell out of there. That would be sensible. But he's kind of curious. A dark part of him wants to know something. Wants to know what his precious girl's ex-lover has between his legs.

He's going to wish he left.

Then, when his obscenely endowed exam mate starts to relate to the nurses the casual but very dirty hook-ups he's been having with an ex, Ben's hands really start sweating.

This is going to be the worst day of Ben's life.

Size Curious Brat

Matt Walsh is on his way home from Harvard. It's Thanksgiving recess and he hasn't been with his sweet Chloe Rose in months. He can't wait to get off the bus and wrap his arms around his baby girl.

Chloe's a perverted little high-schooler with a habit for trouble. She loves her boyfriend Matt and she's been aching for him.

But there's a problem.

Matt's step brother came home early. He's a bully. A domineering man's man who made Matt's life miserable growing up. Now he's a sexy deep-sea welder just getting home from Louisiana after two months at sea and he hasn't even seen a woman in ages.

After a brief, naked encounter in the hallway little Chloe can't get something out of her mind. Matt's stepbrother Moric is built much better than other men and she can't stop thinking about it.

It makes Matt mad but Chloe is just naturally curious. She doesn't think it's a big deal. She's just never seen anything like that before.

Now Moric's got his eyes on his little brother's prize possession. She's not exactly unwilling. Moric is a big powerful stud and Matt is powerless to stop him. Once he starts neither of them could stop him. He could take whatever he wants. It might be better—if Moric would let him—to just join him...